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**Rishi Kapadia**

rishi.kapadia@clsa.com

+91 22 6650 5009

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## SECTOR

Automotive

## MARKET

India

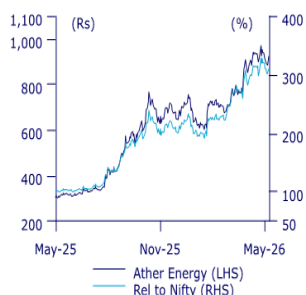
## KEY COMPANIES

Ather Energy (ATHERENE IN)

**12M px tgt** Rs1,450.00  
**+/-%** +57%  
**potential**

### Stock performance (%)

|            | 1M  | 3M   | 12M   |
|------------|-----|------|-------|
| Absolute   | 4.5 | 30.6 | 189.3 |
| Relative   | 3.8 | 38.4 | 198.9 |
| Abs (US\$) | 3.4 | 24.6 | 158.7 |



Price chart and Financials table as at publication date.

# Ather Energy

## Rs922.30 - OUTPERFORM

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## Riding India's EV supercycle

**Structural tailwinds, engineered moat and premiumisation at play**

The electric two-wheeler (e2W) market is at a an inflection point, shifting from policy push to product pull, with volume set to see a c.40% Cagr over FY26–30CL vs c.4% for ICE. Electrification is premium-led and scooter-first—right in Ather Energy's (Ather) sweet spot. Ather, a pure-play e2W maker known for its smart, high-performance scooters and tightly integrated hardware–software stack, is well positioned to capitalise on this shift. With its EL platform structurally bending the cost curve, Ather is now poised to scale into the Rs100k segment and accelerate market share gains. We believe this twin engine of cost deflation and premiumisation will drive c.4x volume growth over the next four years. We initiate coverage with an Outperform rating and an Rs1,450 target price.

### Scaling up and stepping ahead: Disciplined market share gains

Ather's playbook is not volume at any cost, it is premiumisation-led share capture. Distribution expansion, sharper segmentation and entry into the mid-segment via the EL platform, Ather is expanding its addressable market without eroding brand equity. Ather, therefore, is not just participating, it is shaping the category. Despite rising competition and a limited focus from Japanese OEMs, we see Ather gaining market share in e-scooters of to 22% by FY28CL, backed by differentiated products.

### Software moat: Monetisation beyond the vehicle

Ather's edge goes beyond hardware. With a c.90% adoption rate, Ather Stack is a product, not an add-on. This reinforces an insight: consumers are willing to pay for features, connectivity

and continuous upgrades. Non-vehicle revenue (c.13% of FY26 sales) is lifting its ASP and profitability. In a hardware-heavy industry, Ather is quietly building a software flywheel, with full-stack ownership.

### Unit economics inflecting; scale to drive margins

At a negative 6% Ebitda margin currently, Ather may look early-stage but underlying unit economics are already converging with ICE peers. Gross profit/vehicle signals the gap is scale-driven, not structural. With EL set to drive a c.10%–15% BOM reduction and rising scale, margin should expand meaningfully. We expect Ebitda breakeven by FY28CL and c.14.5% by FY32CL, on par with the leading OEMs.

### Initiate coverage of Ather with an O-PF rating and Rs1,450 target price

We value Ather at 40x (+1 std. versus TVS Motor) FY32CL EPS (post margin normalisation), and discount this back to four years using a COE of 13.6%. At its current price our target price implies c. 60% upside and thus we believe Ather can double in three years. Key risks include slower-than-anticipated e2W adoption, as we are building in e2W adoption rising to c.20%-21% by 30CL vs 7% currently.

### Financials

| Year to 31 March        | 25A     | 26A     | 27CL    | 28CL    | 29CL   |
|-------------------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|--------|
| Revenue (Rsm)           | 22,550  | 36,718  | 45,378  | 66,815  | 92,508 |
| Net profit (Rsm)        | (8,123) | (5,172) | (5,025) | (3,546) | 1,367  |
| EPS (Rs)                | (21.2)  | (13.4)  | (13.0)  | (9.1)   | 3.5    |
| CL/consensus (6) (EPS%) | -       | -       | 108     | 153     | 44     |
| FCF yield (%)           | (3.0)   | (1.3)   | (1.8)   | (0.6)   | 1.0    |
| Revenue growth (% YoY)  | 28.6    | 62.8    | 23.6    | 47.2    | 38.5   |
| ROE (%)                 | (156.4) | (33.7)  | (21.6)  | (18.7)  | 7.7    |
| Net debt/equity (%)     | 80.5    | (42.8)  | (21.4)  | (8.7)   | (24.4) |
| P/Sales (x)             | 15.7    | 9.7     | 7.9     | 5.4     | 3.9    |

Source: www.clsa.com

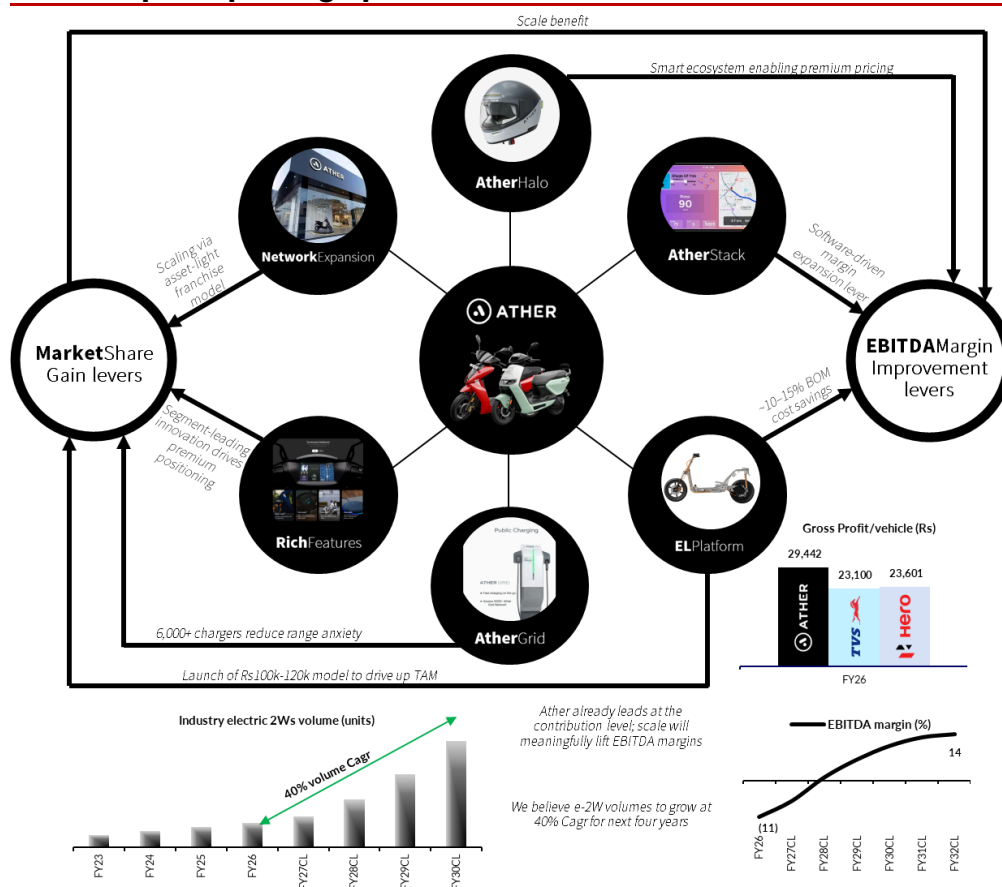
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Figure 1

## Ather market share and Ebitda margin improvement levers with e2W adoption picking up



Source: Company, SIAM, TVS Motor, Hero MotoCorp, CLSA

## 1. Ather's Playbook: Built to win, not just compete

### Ather Energy: Premium DNA, now scaling down the price curve without diluting the brand

Ather's playbook in the Indian e2W market has been refreshingly contrarian. While the industry gravitated early towards sub-Rs100k mass-market scooters –often sacrificing features, reliability, and margins in pursuit of volumes– Ather doubled down on its premium positioning. With flagship models priced north of Rs150k, the company built its franchise on superior product engineering, a tightly integrated hardware–software ecosystem, and continuous feature innovation.

This disciplined approach has yielded two key outcomes: strong premium brand recall and a structurally higher margin profile versus peers caught in price wars.

### From premium niche to affordable premium: Enter the EL platform

Ather is now at an inflection point. With the launch of its new EL platform, the company is strategically expanding into the Rs100k–Rs120k segment–

arguably the most contested zone in the e-scooter market. However, this is not a pivot away from its core philosophy, but rather an extension of it.

Our read: ***Ather is not 'going mass', it is premiumising the mass.***

This distinction matters. In consumer categories, especially mobility, brand laddering tends to work better than down-trading. Ather's ability to introduce superior features at a mid-tier price point, while retaining premium brand cues, positions it uniquely to capture share without entering a margin-destructive race.

Figure 2

### Ather is entering into mass segment with EL platform

| Category     | Price bucket | No. of variants (BOTV) | No. of Ather variants | EL-Enabled growth lever |
|--------------|--------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|
| Premium      | >Rs150k      | 4                      | 6                     | EL to expand margins    |
| Mass Premium | Rs125k-150k  | 6                      | 3                     |                         |
| Mass         | Rs100k-125k  | 12                     | 0                     | EL to expand TAM        |
| Entry        | <Rs100k      | 10                     |                       |                         |

Source: Company, CLSA Note: BOTV - EVs from Bajaj, Ola, TVS and Vida; Ather Variants include AtherStack Pro in the price as the attach rates are high

### Premiumisation tailwind in 2Ws—Ather is early, not late

We continue to anchor our thesis around premiumization in Indian 2Ws, a trend already visible in ICE motorcycles, ICE scooters and now unfolding in EVs. Early adopters of electric scooters skew towards:

- Urban, affluent consumers
- Tech-savvy buyers willing to experiment
- Users less sensitive to re-sale value, but more focused on experience (consumers who buy smartphones on EMI)

Entry-market adoption, in contrast, is gated by structural concerns:

- Resale value uncertainty
- Charging infrastructure gaps
- Higher perceived servicing complexity (limited third-party ecosystem)

This suggests the initial EV penetration curve is likely to be top-down, not bottom-up. Ather, with its stronghold in the premium segment, is thus structurally better positioned versus peers chasing entry-level volumes.

### Ather Stack: The silent margin engine

One of Ather's most underappreciated strengths is its proprietary software ecosystem—Ather Stack. With an attach rate exceeding c.90%, the platform is a clear validation consumers are willing to pay for a connected, feature-rich riding experience.

This has multiple implications:

1. ASP Uplift: Bundled software features enhance realization per vehicle
2. Margin Accretion: High incremental margins on software versus vehicle
3. Lock-in Effect: Deep integration increases customer stickiness, and consumers are therefore more willing to replace their vehicle with the



same brand

Importantly, this is not easily replicable. Ather's full-stack approach—where software is designed in-house and tightly integrated with hardware—creates a differentiated user experience. In contrast, many competitors rely on outsourced or modular software solutions, limiting their ability to offer seamless, continuously evolving features.

### **Bottom line: A structured share gainer**

Ather's strategy is now converging into a powerful trifecta:

- premium brand equity built over years of disciplined positioning,
- segment expansion via the EL platform without diluting core proposition, and
- high-margin software layer reinforcing both profitability and differentiation.

In a market where most players are trading margins for volumes, Ather is attempting the reverse, driving volume through premiumization.

We believe this positions Ather as a likely structural market share gainer in the evolving e2W landscape.

## **2. EL Platform: Quiet reinvention of the cost curve**

What Ather has done with the EL platform is far more nuanced than a conventional "cost-down" exercise—it is a full-stack re-engineering of the scooter, aimed at structurally bending the cost curve without diluting the brand's premium DNA.

At the core of this transformation lies a rethink of material strategy. Ather's legacy platforms leaned heavily on aluminium—a choice that aligned with its premium positioning but came at a cost. The EL platform pivots to a steel unibody architecture, materially lowering input costs while retaining structural integrity through smarter design. This single shift alone is meaningful, given aluminium's significantly higher cost relative to steel, and represents the first leg of Ather's structural cost reset.

But the real magic lies not in material substitution but simplification. The EL platform is designed with a far more integrated architecture, including a simplified drivetrain and the introduction of a charge drive controller that combines the motor controller and charger into a single unit. This is not incremental engineering; it is subtractive innovation—removing components altogether rather than negotiating them down. Fewer parts translate into lower procurement costs, reduced assembly complexity, and faster manufacturing cycles. Ather has indicated that assembly speeds improve meaningfully under this architecture.

Layered on top of this is platform modularity—arguably the most powerful lever in Ather's arsenal. EL is not a single product architecture but a scalable base that can underpin multiple scooters across price points, battery configurations, and use cases. This allows Ather to spread R&D costs, drive supplier scale benefits, and standardize components across its portfolio. For a

company transitioning from niche premium volume to broader market participation, this shift from product-led to platform-led thinking is critical. It also aligns with the commissioning of its new high-capacity manufacturing facility, which further strengthens scale economics and vertical integration.

Putting these elements together, our assessment suggests that the EL platform can structurally reduce Ather's bill of materials by c.10%–15%. This estimate triangulates the impact of material substitution, component reduction, modular scale benefits, and integration efficiencies. Importantly, this level of cost reduction is not superficial—it is deeply embedded in the product architecture, making it sustainable rather than cyclical.

In essence, EL is not a cost-cutting platform but a margin design platform.

Figure 3

## EL platform

### EL - Scooter Platform

Designed to meet the evolving and diverse needs of electric scooter buyers



Source: Company

## 3. Domestic e2W industry

e2W registrations in FY26 are up 22% YoY versus internal combustion engine (ICE) 2W registrations increasing at just 14% YoY, resulting in the e2W mix rising 45bps YoY, to 6.5%. Despite this progress, e2W adoption in India has not fully met consensus expectations relative the overall 2W market size. Several challenges have constrained faster adoption:

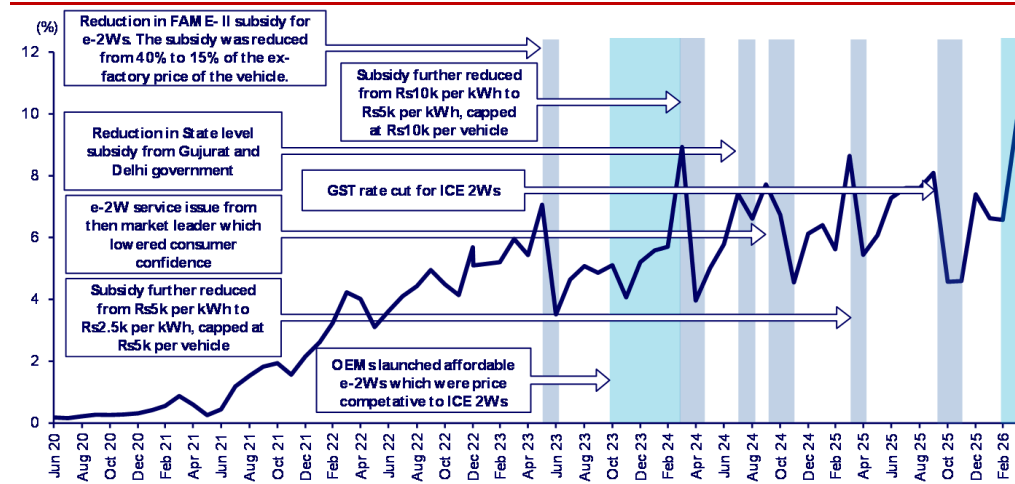
- **Reduced PM E-Drive subsidy.** The subsidy for e2Ws has declined from more than Rs20,000 per vehicle under FAME-I to Rs5,000 per vehicle currently, and this has led to higher upfront costs for the consumers.
- **Reduced state subsidies.** Some states have reduced the state level subsidy for e2Ws which has impacted sales in those states.
- **Servicing issues.** Our market research reveals key players have had issues with vehicle servicing that have lowered consumer confidence in e2Ws.
- **Range anxiety.** Most electric scooters and motorcycles offer limited real-world ranges (the actual distance an EV can travel on a full charge

under typical driving conditions) of 70km-150km, which restricts their appeal for longer commutes or rural users.

- Gaps in charging infrastructure. While improving, the charging network across India is still sparse in many regions, especially outside tier 1 cities.
- Battery technology and replacement costs. Concerns about battery life, replacement costs and resale value persist among consumers.

Figure 4

### e2W adoption in India



Source: Vahan, CLSA

The PM E-Drive Scheme, launched in August 2024, has continued the central government's series of calibrated subsidy reductions begun with FAME II in 2023. Initially, the plan maintained the Rs5,000/kWh subsidy and the cap of Rs10,000 per vehicle until March 2025. From April 2025 onwards, the subsidy was further halved to Rs2,500 per kWh, with a vehicle cap of Rs5,000, signalling a strategic shift towards market-driven growth and reduced dependence on government incentives. Government has expected the PM E-Drive subsidy till July-2026.

The subsidy trajectory all the way from FAME-I through PM E-Drive illustrates India's longer-term transition from heavy demand-side incentives towards a more sustainable, innovation-driven EV ecosystem. The gradual reduction in the per-kWh subsidy and per-vehicle cap aligns with improving battery technology, declining manufacturing costs and the maturing of the market, while the PM E-Drive's expanded scope underscores the government's commitment to a holistic transition to EVs.

Figure 5

### Change in subsidies for e2Ws

| Scheme     | Timeline             | Subsidy per kWh (Rs) | Cap per vehicle          |
|------------|----------------------|----------------------|--------------------------|
| FAME - I   | Apr 2015 to Mar 2019 | 5,000                | na                       |
| FAME - II  | Apr 2019 to Nov 2020 | 10,000               | 20% of ex-showroom price |
| FAME - II  | Dec 2020 to May 2023 | 15,000               | 40% of ex-showroom price |
| FAME - II  | Jun 2023 to Mar 2024 | 15,000               | 15% of ex-showroom price |
| EMPS       | Apr 2024 to Jul 2024 | 5,000                | Rs10,000                 |
| PM E-Drive | Aug 2024 to Mar 2025 | 5,000                | Rs10,000                 |
| PM E-Drive | Apr 2025 to Jul 2026 | 2,500                | Rs5,000                  |

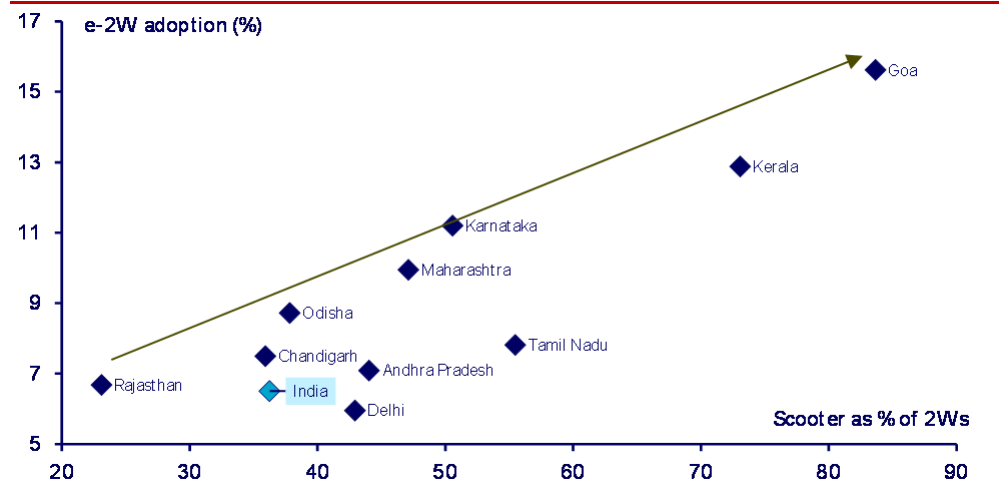
Source: Government of India, CLSA

E2W registrations rose 22% YoY in FY26, with the adoption rate rising to 6.5%, driven by the launch of more affordable e2Ws and pre-buying in Mar 2026 with the anticipation of the PM E-Drive subsidy being pushed out, which the government extended to Jul 2026. All OEMs have announced plans to launch a range of affordable e2Ws. In India, states with a higher proportion of scooters in their 2W mix, such as Goa, Kerala and Karnataka, have consistently exhibited higher adoption rates for e2Ws than states where motorcycles dominate. This pattern is evident both in market penetration statistics and in consumer behaviour.

- **Goa:** With a 13% penetration rate for e2Ws, one of the highest in the country. Scooters have historically made up a large share of Goa's 2W population, reflecting urban mobility needs where scooters are preferred over motorcycles for convenience, comfort and short commutes.
- **Kerala:** With a 14% e2W adoption rate, Kerala also has a scooter-dominant 2W market. Scooters are preferred by a wide range of buyers, including women and older citizens, making it conducive for early electric adoption.
- **Karnataka:** 13% e2W adoption, with a strong urban base (Bengaluru) and robust charging infrastructure. Scooters account for a large share of vehicle registrations, and factors such as environmental awareness, local commuting patterns and progressive EV policies are driving the transition to electric models.

Figure 6

### e2W adoption and scooter mix across states in FY25



Source: SIAM, Vahan, CLSA

#### 1. Urbanisation and usage patterns

Scooter-heavy states typically have larger urban populations. Scooters are well-suited for stop-and-go city traffic, short distances and ease of parking - attributes that align closely with the range, performance and low running cost of e2Ws.

#### 2. Preference for convenience and comfort

Scooters offer a step-through design, automatic transmission and easy handling, making them attractive for a broader demographic. These features are almost universally present in e2Ws, particularly e-scooters, making transition familiar and appealing.

### 3. Demographic and cultural factors

**Higher female ownership:** States with a higher scooter mix typically see higher female ridership and ownership, a group that is increasingly adopting e-scooters due to their ease of use and lower operational costs.

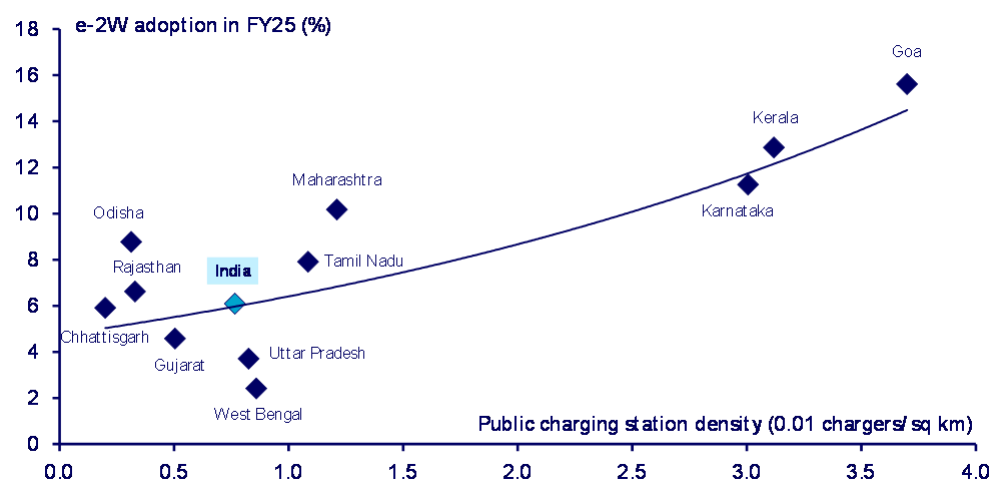
**Youth and middle-aged population:** Young professionals and older commuters prefer scooters; openness to electric mobility is higher in these demographics.

Based on these factors, as the share of scooters rises in India we believe the adoption for e2Ws will continue to increase.

The availability of charging stations has a direct impact on the adoption of EVs. With more charging stations, potential EV owners are reassured that they will not be left stranded due to a lack of charging options. This has led to a surge in the number of e2Ws on Indian roads. Several Indian states have seen a relationship between the density of charging stations (charging station per km<sup>2</sup>) and the adoption of electric cars. For instance, states like Kerala and Karnataka, with more charging stations per km<sup>2</sup>, have reported a higher adoption of e2Ws.

Figure 7

#### State charging networks versus e2W adoption



Source: Government of India, Vahan, CLSA

India's e2W market is enjoying robust growth and evolving competitive dynamics, reflecting the increase in consumer adoption and improving infrastructure. Legacy automakers are gaining significant ground, intensifying competition with early EV disruptors. TVS Motor has emerged as the market leader, followed by Bajaj Auto. Ather Energy has been gaining ground to become the market leader in the south of India. On the other hand, Ola Electric has lost market share to these players. However, all OEMs are launching a range of affordable e-scooters in their product portfolios, and this has led to market share gains for most of them. While Bajaj Auto and TVS already have wide service networks, new incumbents are rapidly expanding their networks to fill the gap with these legacy players.

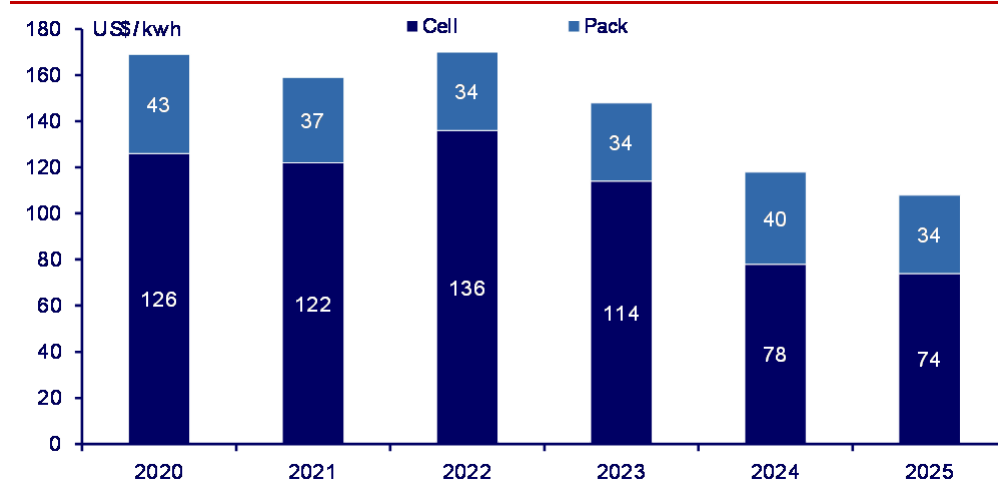
Government incentives such as the FAME and EMPS subsidy schemes continue to support the segment, though subsidy rates are down, with current schemes offering only Rs2,500 per kWh of battery capacity capped at 15% of the vehicle's factory price. Despite the reduced incentives compared with earlier years, sales momentum remains strong.

### Key growth drivers:

- Improved product availability, with legacy original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) such as TVS Motor, Bajaj Auto, Hero MotoCorp and Ather Energy having launched a range of affordable e2W models.
- Expansion of charging infrastructure, supporting consumer confidence.
- Incentives and subsidy schemes, such as the Government of India's PM Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement (PM E-Drive) plan for vehicles with permanent magnet (PM) motors, offering a Rs2,500 per kWh battery subsidy, capped at Rs5,000 per vehicle.
- Increasing consumer awareness and environmental concerns.
- Reduction in battery cost leading to reduction in upfront acquisition cost.

Figure 8

### Lithium-battery price



Source: BNEF, CLSA

### Batteries used in India for EVs

India's varied driving conditions and diverse terrain require EV batteries that prioritise reliability, durability, performance and safety. Currently, the most suitable and effective battery types for EVs in this context are lithium iron phosphate (LFP) and nickel manganese cobalt (NMC) batteries.

**LFP batteries:** LFP batteries are favoured for their longevity, reliability, cost-effectiveness, and safety features. They are generally more stable than NMC batteries and operate effectively over a broader temperature range, from 0°C to 45°C (32°F to 113°F). LFP batteries can endure a higher number of charge and discharge cycles without significant capacity degradation. In India's EV ecosystem, LFP batteries are also less susceptible to thermal runaway, a dangerous condition in which a battery overheats and potentially ignites, making them particularly suitable for regions with high temperatures. As a result, LFP batteries are better suited for extreme climates and offer enhanced safety compared with NMC batteries. However, the safety gap between the two battery types is rapidly closing due to advancements in Battery Management System (BMS) technology and other innovative measures aimed at preventing and mitigating thermal runaway.

**NMC batteries:** NMC batteries excel in energy density, allowing them to store more energy within a compact form factor. This characteristic enables EVs to achieve greater power output and extended range while minimising weight. In

addition, NMC batteries offer versatility and adaptability, as their performance can be tailored to various applications by adjusting the ratios of nickel, manganese, and cobalt in the cathode. As a result, approximately 60% of EVs sold worldwide now utilise NMC battery technology.

Figure 9

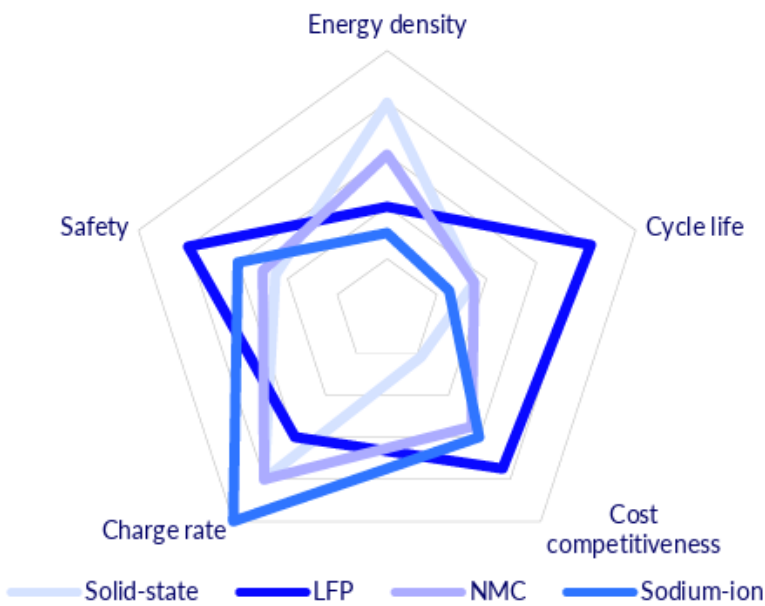
Different battery chemistry and their features and specifications

| Features & Specifications      | LFP       | NMC       | LCO      | LTO        | NCA       |
|--------------------------------|-----------|-----------|----------|------------|-----------|
| Energy density (Wh/kg)         | 90-150    | 150-220   | 150-250  | 50-100     | 200-280   |
| Power density (W/kg)           | 300-500   | 600-1000  | 300-500  | 1000-3000  | 800-1500  |
| Cycle life                     | 2000-4000 | 1000-2000 | 500-1000 | 5000-10000 | 1000-2000 |
| Charge and discharge rates     | 1C-3C     | 1C-3C     | 1C-3C    | 5C-50C     | 1C-3C     |
| Thermal stability              | High      | Medium    | Low      | Very high  | High      |
| Recyclability                  | Yes       | Yes       | Yes      | Yes        | Yes       |
| Capacity retention (per cycle) | Low       | Medium    | Varies   | Lowest     | Medium    |
| Cost (\$/kWh)                  | 100-150   | 150-200   | 200-250  | 300-400    | 200-250   |

Note: Green, Turquoise, light blue and dark blue indicate the performance categories Excellent, Good, Average and Below Average. Source: BNEF, CLSA

Figure 10

Status of battery performance metrics



Source: BNEF, CLSA

Advantages of LFP batteries versus MNC batteries:

- **Extended lifespan:** LFP batteries can endure thousands of charge and discharge cycles, depending on their usage and maintenance practices, making them a durable choice for EVs.
- **Enhanced safety:** LFP batteries present a lower risk of fire or explosion compared with other battery types, as they do not contain cobalt, a metal known for its volatility and toxicity.
- **Eco-friendly composition:** LFP batteries are more environmentally sustainable, as they avoid the use of scarce and costly metals such as cobalt and nickel, reducing their ecological footprint.



### Advantages of NMC batteries versus LFP batteries:

- **Higher energy density:** NMC batteries offer greater energy density than LFP batteries, enabling EVs to achieve increased range and enhanced performance.
- **Compact size:** NMC batteries are smaller than LFP batteries, which helps to minimise space and weight requirements within the EV.

**Higher voltage:** NMC batteries operate at a higher voltage than LFP batteries, allowing for fewer cells to be used to deliver the same power output. This characteristic simplifies the battery management system and can lead to cost reductions.

### How using an e2W leads to higher annual savings relative ICE 2Ws

Switching from a petrol-powered (ICE) 2W to an e2W in India results in substantial annual savings, due primarily to lower running and maintenance costs.

#### 1. Significantly lower running costs

- **Electricity versus petrol:** Charging an e2W typically costs only Rs0.3-0.8/km, while running a petrol scooter costs around >Rs2.0/km, depending on fuel prices and efficiency and petrol price across states.
- **Annual fuel savings:** For a typical annual distance of 6,000km:
  1. **e2W:** Rs2,500-3,000 per year on electricity.
  2. **Petrol 2W:** Rs13,500-15,000 per year on petrol.
- **Net annual savings:** Owners can save Rs10,000 or more each year on fuel alone.

#### 2. Lower maintenance expenses

- **Fewer moving parts:** e2Ws have simpler drivetrains and do not require oil changes, clutch replacements, or exhaust maintenance.
- **Annual maintenance costs:** EVs typically incur Rs1,000-3,000 per year in maintenance, compared with Rs4,000-6,000 for ICE scooters.

#### 3. Additional cost advantages

- **Government incentives:** Many states offer exemptions on road tax and registration fees for EVs, further reducing ownership costs.
- **Insurance:** While insurance for EVs can be slightly higher, the difference is often offset by the much lower running and maintenance costs.

#### 4. Battery replacement would be required for EVs at least once

- **Battery replacement:** The Li-battery would be depleted through the life of the e2W, so the consumer would have to replace the battery at least once through the life of the scooter.

Choosing an e2W over a petrol-powered model in India delivers substantial annual savings for consumers, primarily through sharply lower fuel and maintenance costs. These financial benefits, combined with government incentives and environmental advantages, make e2Ws a smart and sustainable

mobility solution for Indian consumers. The lower total cost of ownership (TCO) in recent years is likely to gradually increase the adoption of e2Ws.

Figure 11

### Running cost savings for e2Ws versus ICE

|                                                             | TVS<br>Jupiter | TVS<br>iQube   | TVS<br>iQube   | TVS<br>iQube   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| Battery Capacity (kWh)                                      |                | 2.2            | 3.1            | 3.5            |
| Ex-showroom Price (Rs)                                      | 75,600         | 106,735        | 115,634        | 130,109        |
| <b>On-Road Price (Rs)</b>                                   | <b>89,900</b>  | <b>108,433</b> | <b>117,432</b> | <b>132,070</b> |
| Annual Kms run                                              | 6,000          | 6,000          | 6,000          | 6,000          |
| City Range (km)                                             |                | 75             | 95             | 115            |
| Running cost on home charge per km (Rs)                     |                | 0.3            | 0.3            | 0.3            |
| Running cost while charging at fast charger (Rs/km)         |                | 0.7            | 0.8            | 0.8            |
| Running cost per km (Rs)                                    | 2.3            | 0.4            | 0.5            | 0.4            |
| Annual electricity cost (Rs) (70% Home + 30% Fast Charging) | -              | 2,429          | 2,702          | 2,520          |
| Annual fuel cost (Rs)                                       | 13,800         | -              | -              | -              |
| Annual maintenance cost (Rs)                                | 5,000          | 2,000          | 2,000          | 2,000          |
| One-time battery replacement for EVs (Rs)                   | -              | 15,400         | 21,700         | 24,500         |
| Average life of scooter (years)                             | 12             | 12             | 12             | 12             |
| Lifetime cost (Rs)                                          | 315,500        | 176,979        | 195,555        | 210,810        |
| <b>Average annual savings of EV vs ICE (Rs)</b>             |                | <b>11,543</b>  | <b>9,995</b>   | <b>8,724</b>   |

Source: TVS Motor, CLSA

## Policy changes

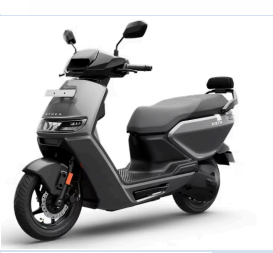
### Delhi EV draft policy:

The Draft Delhi Electric Vehicle Policy 2026–2030 is very supportive of e2Ws, combining near-term incentives with a clear terminal ban of ICE models, which materially improves long-term demand visibility. The policy proposes a complete ban on new registrations of petrol/CNG two-wheelers from 1 April 2028, structurally mandating a full transition to e2Ws in Delhi. To accelerate adoption ahead of this deadline, the government has introduced front-loaded purchase incentives for e2Ws priced up to Rs 225k, offering Rs 10,000/kWh (capped at Rs 30,000) in year one, tapering to Rs 6,600/kWh (Rs 20,000 cap) in year two and Rs 3,300/kWh (Rs 10,000 cap) in year three, thereby incentivising early purchases and favouring mass-market, lower-battery commuter models. The policy also retains 100% exemption from road tax and registration fees for EVs until March 2030, enhancing e2W total cost of ownership.

Figure 12

### Major e-scooter in market (ex-showroom price)

| Company                                                                              | Model  | Base Variant (Rs) | Top Variant (Rs) |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------------|------------------|
| Bajaj                                                                                | Chetak | 109,957           | 144,140          |
|  |        |                   |                  |
| TVS                                                                                  | iQube  | 113,245           | 171,348          |
|   |        |                   |                  |

|       |         |         |         |                                                                                     |
|-------|---------|---------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hero  | Vida    | 99,490  | 144,495 |    |
| Ather | 450     | 125,422 | 190,412 |   |
| Ather | Rizta   | 115,724 | 154,206 |   |
| TVS   | Orbiter | 95,243  | 113,731 |  |

Source: Company, Bajaj Auto, Hero MotoCorp, TVS, CLSA

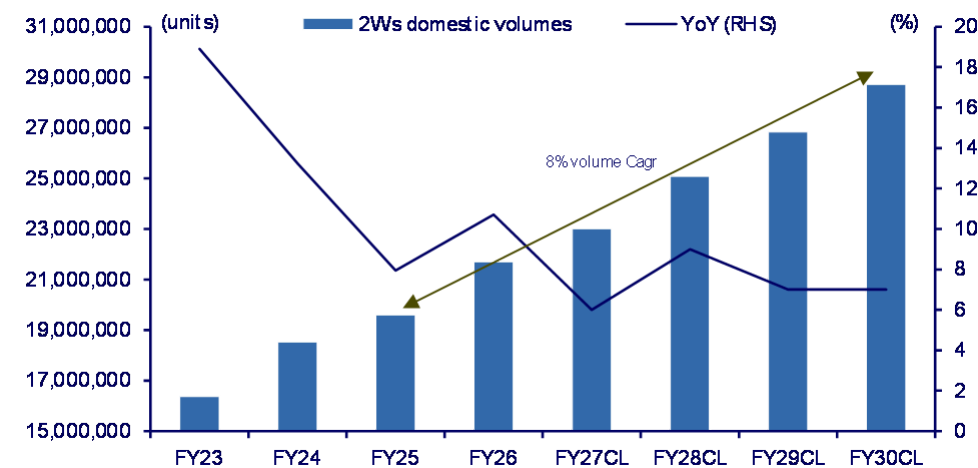
We believe EV adoption in 2Ws will rise

We are building in an c.8% volume Cagr for the domestic 2W industry. Within this, we expect a mix shift to play out in favour of scooters, driven by two key underappreciated trends—premiumiation and rising female workforce participation.

Premiumiation is steadily reshaping consumer preferences, with buyers increasingly prioritising convenience, ease of use and feature-rich offerings over bare-bones mobility. Scooters, by design, are better positioned to capture this shift given their automatic transmission, practicality, and improving design appeal. At the same time, the increasing participation of women in the workforce is structurally expanding the addressable market for scooters. As these trends gather pace, we expect scooters to gain share within the overall 2W mix in a calibrated but consistent manner over the medium term.

Figure 13

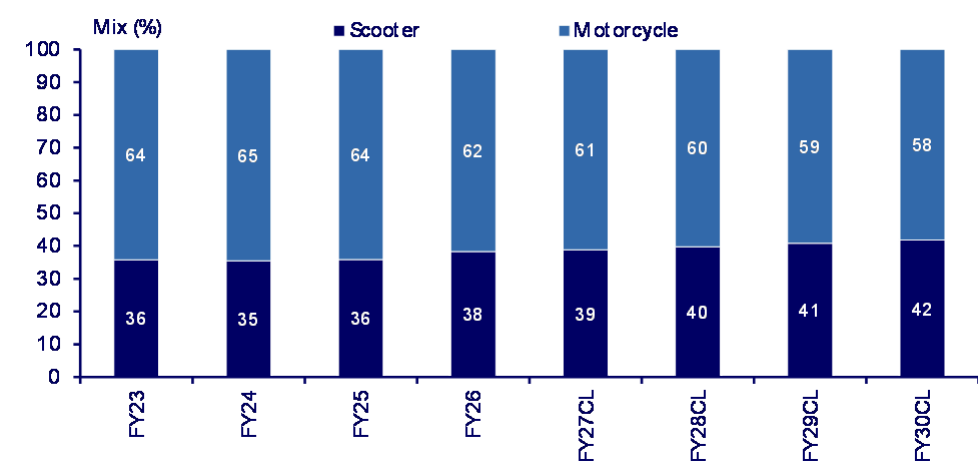
2W domestic volume



Source: SIAM, CLSA

Figure 14

### 2W domestic industry mix (%)



Source: Company, CLSA

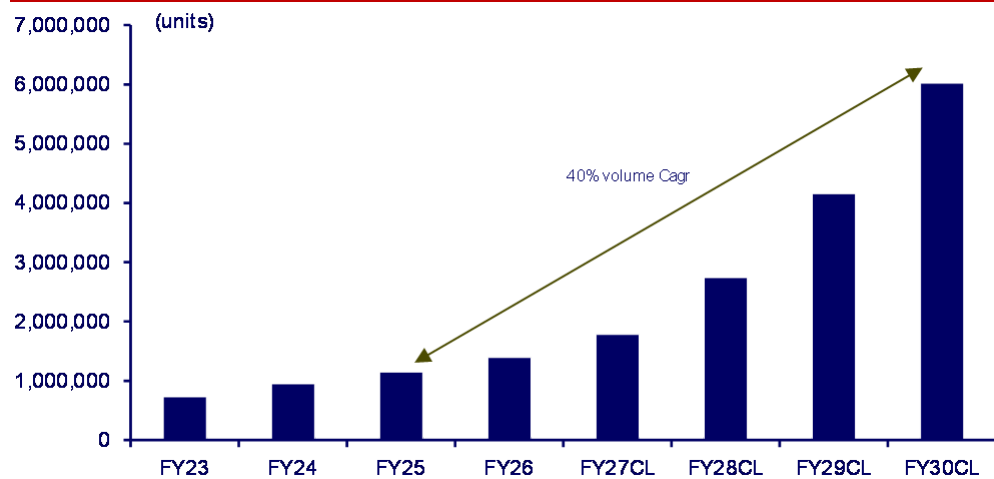
We believe the electric 2W transition in India is now moving from policy-led adoption to product-led acceleration. Supported by continued government push, materially richer feature offerings, and a structurally lower cost of ownership versus ICE vehicles, e2Ws are increasingly emerging as a compelling consumer proposition rather than just an alternative.

As a result, we expect EV penetration in 2Ws to scale meaningfully, with adoption rising to c.20%-21% by FY30CL. Importantly, this transition is unlikely to be uniform across segments—scooters are expected to lead the electrification curve, given their urban use case and lower running range versus motorcycle.

This sharp acceleration in adoption implies a divergent growth trajectory within the industry. We model e2W volume growing at a c.40% CAGR over FY26–30CL, underpinned by both penetration gains and absolute category expansion. In contrast, ICE 2Ws are likely to see a structurally lower growth trajectory of c.4% CAGR, as electrification begins to cannibalise incremental demand.

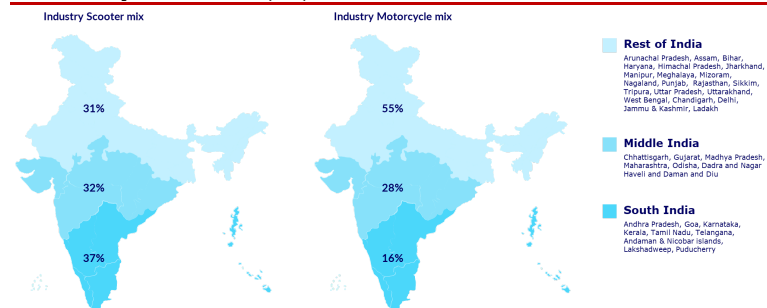
Against this backdrop, pure-play EV OEMs such as Ather are structurally better positioned. Unlike legacy incumbents managing dual portfolios and channel conflicts, Ather benefits from a singular EV-focused strategy, tighter product-market fit in scooters, and an ecosystem-built ground-up for electric mobility.

Figure 15

**Electric 2W volume**

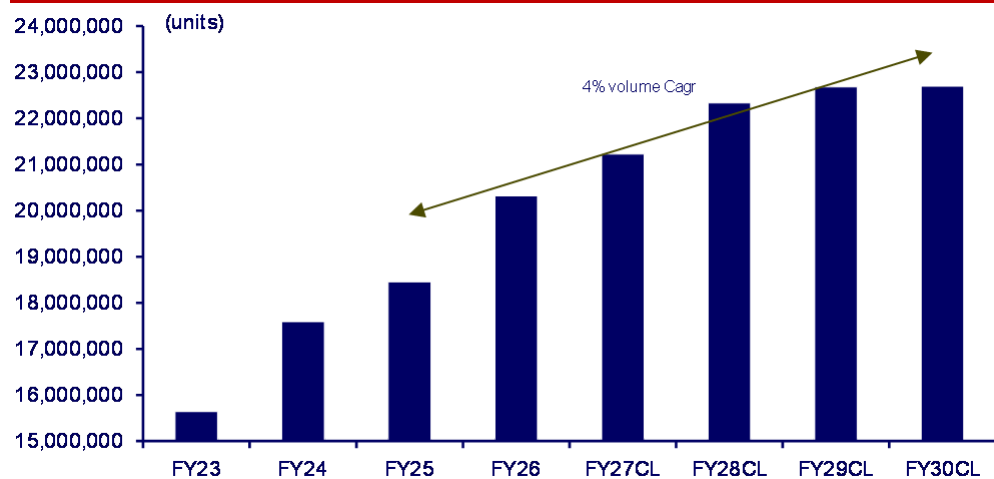
Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 16

**Industry 2W mix (%)**

Source: SIAM, CLSA

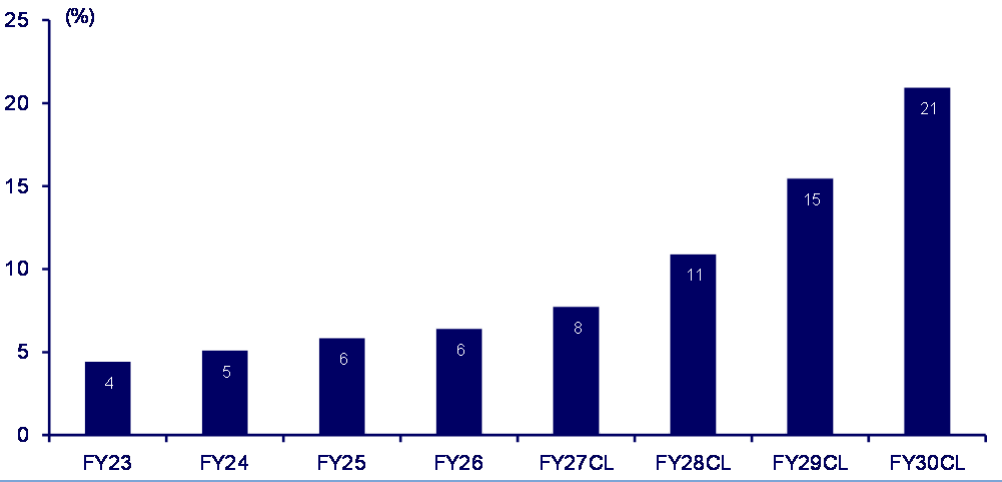
Figure 17

**ICE 2W volume**

Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 18

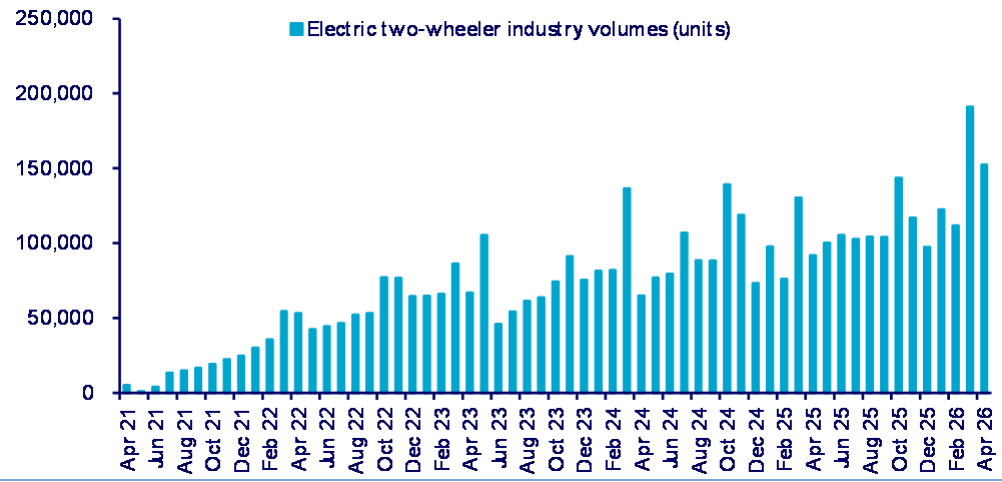
**Adoption of electric 2Ws**



Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 19

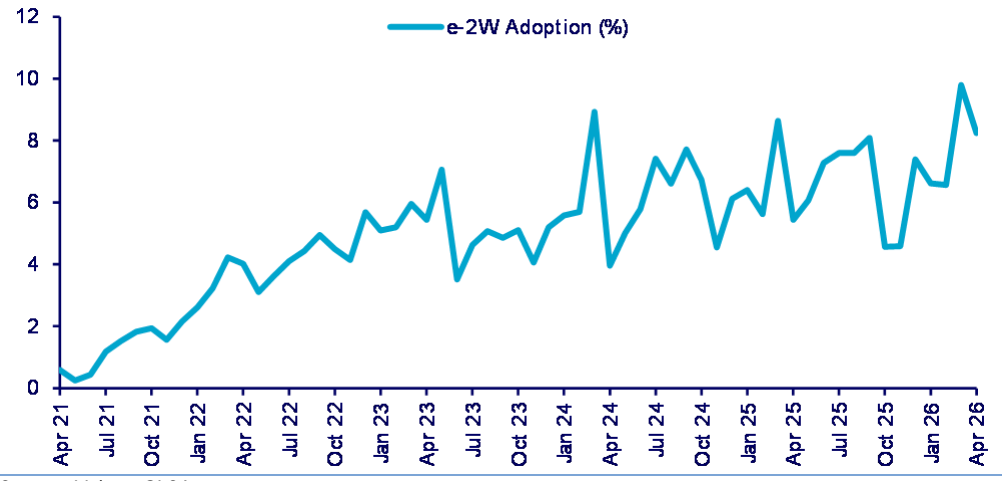
Domestic e2W industry volume



Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 20

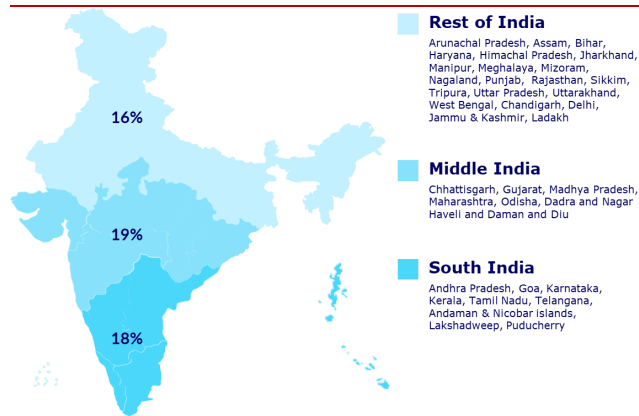
e2W adoption (%)



Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 21

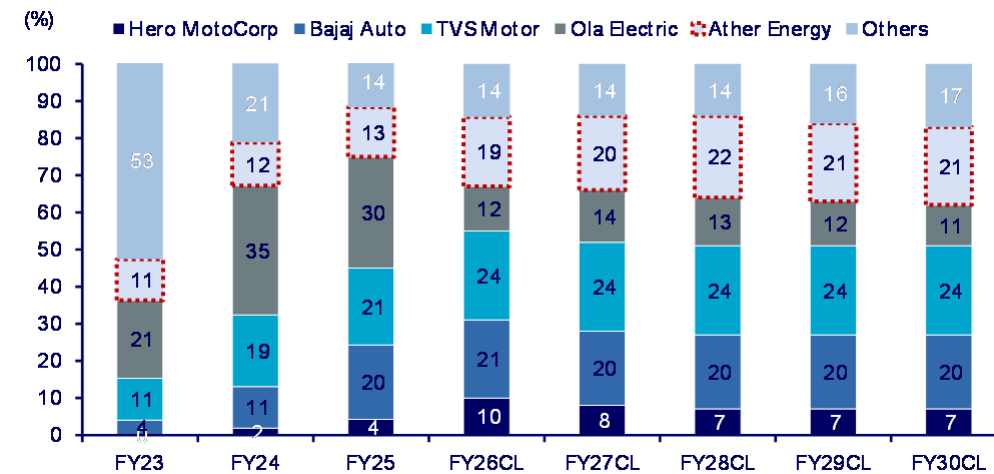
Adoption of e2Ws in scooters (%)



Source: Company, CLSA

Figure 22

## Market share of electric scooters in India



Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 23

## Ather market share in India

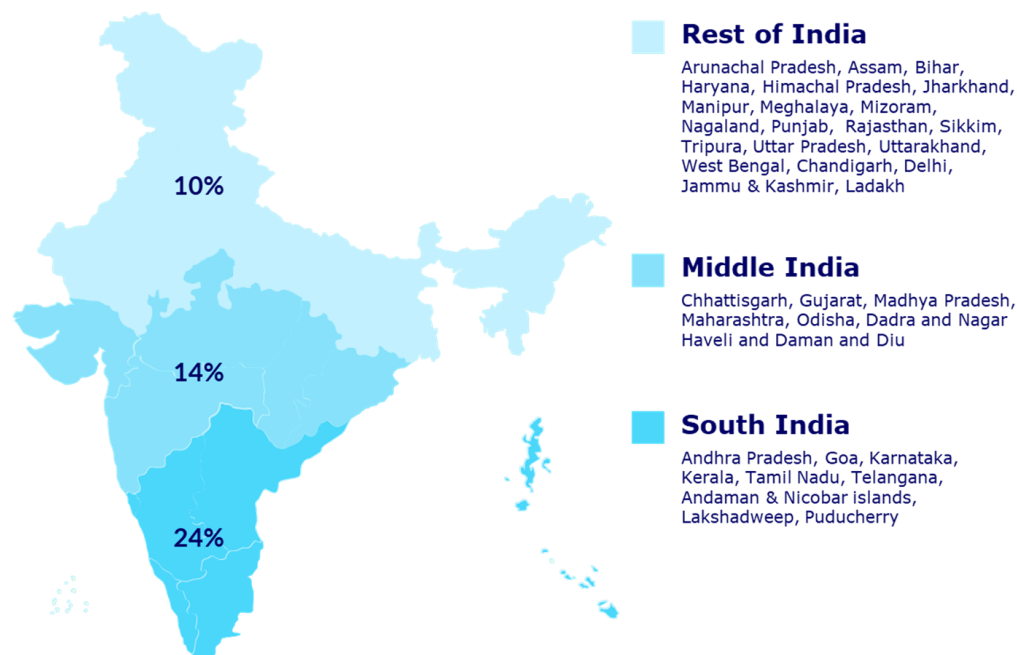


Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 24

## Ather market share (%) in 2025



**Ather market share (%)**

Source: SIAM, Vahan, CLSA

## 4. Ather has been gaining market share

Ather Energy has been consistently gaining market share in India's e2W segment, supported by portfolio expansion into lower price points, rapid physical network scaling, and strong product differentiation. Per Vahan and industry data, Ather's national e2W market share has expanded from c.11–12% in FY24 to c.18% across FY26, positioning it among the top three players in the category.

### Portfolio expansion: Rizta addresses the mass family segment

- A key catalyst for recent volume and share gains has been the launch of Ather Rizta, the company's first family-oriented electric scooter, in April 2024. Rizta meaningfully expands Ather's addressable market beyond its earlier premium-sporty positioning (450X and 450S), which were largely priced above Rs125k (ex-showroom).
- The Rizta is priced from c.Rs105k–Rs110k ex-showroom, with higher variants extending to c.Rs145k, thereby opening a materially lower entry price point for the brand.
- Over FY25–FY26, Rizta has emerged as Ather's volume anchor, accounting for c.60–70% of sales. However, there has been some cannibalisation with the launch of the Rizta, with the volume for the 450 series declining.
- The product is positioned directly against ICE family scooters (eg., Activa) and mass EV peers, offering class-leading storage, safety features, and ride comfort, which has supported strong traction in tier-II/III markets.

This portfolio diversification has materially broadened Ather's customer base while preserving brand premia through feature differentiation.

### Product differentiation and continuous software-led innovation

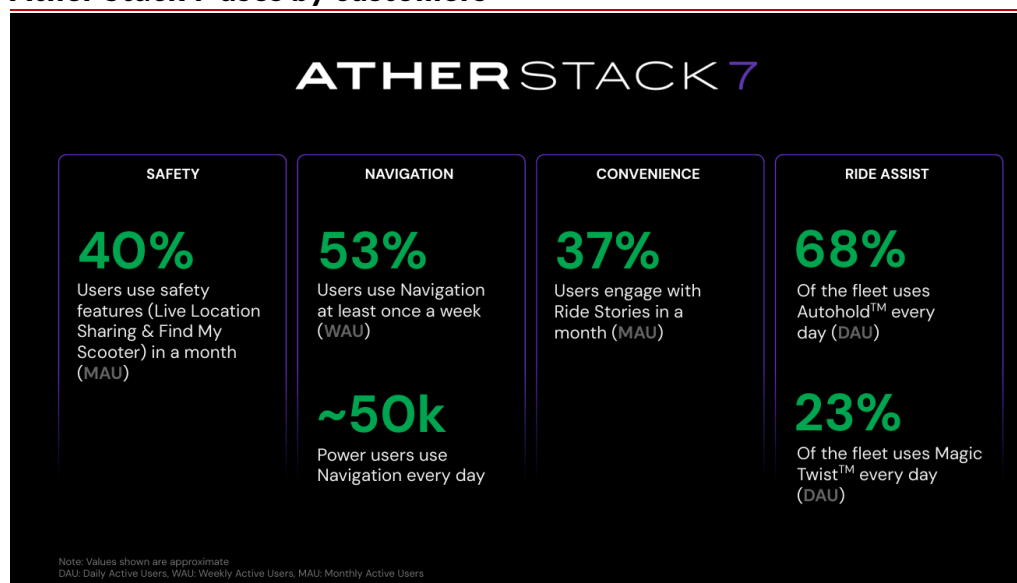
Ather's scooters remain feature-rich versus most incumbent EV offerings, driven by deep in-house engineering across hardware, software, and user experience. Key differentiators include:

- Touchscreen dashboard with navigation and real-time vehicle analytics
- OTA (over-the-air) updates enabling continuous feature addition
- Patented ride-assist features such as AutoHold™, Magic Twist™, SkidControl™, and advanced safety alerts

Importantly, Ather has followed a continuous improvement model, regularly rolling out new software features across both new and existing vehicles, reinforcing customer stickiness and brand differentiation.

Figure 25

### Ather Stack 7 uses by customers



Source: Company

### Network expansion: Charging plus service as competitive moat

Parallel to product expansion, Ather has aggressively scaled its physical ecosystem, addressing one of the key adoption barriers in EVs—after-sales reliability and range anxiety.

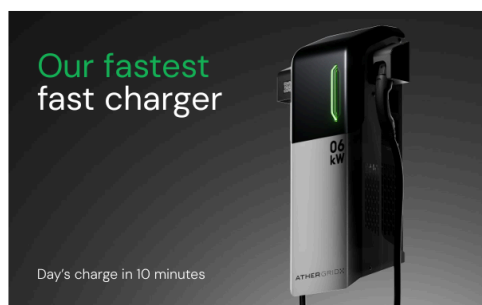
- Fast-charging network (Ather Grid): Expanded to c.6,000+ fast-charging points across 350–380+ cities in India (and select international markets).
- Service network: Doubled over the last year to c.500 authorised service centres, with ExpressCare (60-minute service) live at c.80+ locations.
- Retail footprint: c.600 experience centres as of 3QFY26, with management guiding to c.700 centres by end-FY26.

This integrated approach, simultaneously scaling sales, charging, and services, has helped Ather deliver a more predictable and premium ownership experience relative to peers that rely on thinner or third-party networks.

Figure 26

### Ather charging network

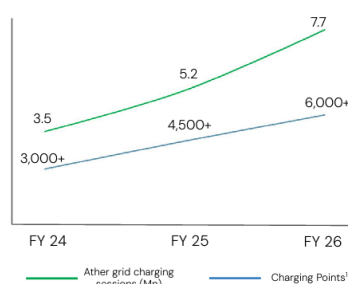
## Consistent focus on ecosystem: Expanding margins and deepening moats



**6,000+**  
Charging points<sup>1</sup> (+1,143 YoY)

Operated on **LECCS**

Charging sessions grew by 2.2x along with grid



Note: 1. As on 31 March 2026 & charging points includes fast charging points (including Vida + other CPOs) and neighbourhood chargers.

Source: Company

## Software stack as a structural profitability lever

Ather's in-house software platform, AtherStack, represents a structural differentiator versus several EV OEMs that outsource software development.

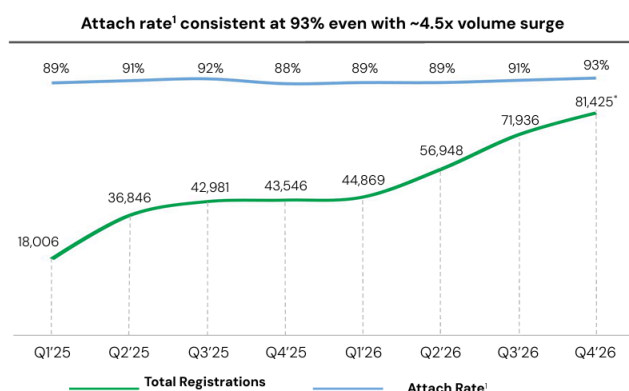
- Paid software offerings (AtherStack Pro) now have a c.90% attach rate, driven by high perceived utility among customers.
- Non-vehicle revenue (software, charging, service, spares) accounted for c.14% of total revenue in 3QFY26, carrying meaningfully higher gross margins versus vehicle sales.
- Management has highlighted software and ecosystem revenue as a key driver behind the sharp improvement in Ebitda margins.

This software-led monetisation model improves lifetime value per customer and provides Ather with additional levers to drive profitability as volumes scale.

Figure 27

## Ather Stack 7 attach rate at c.90%

Consistent focus on ecosystem: Expanding margins and deepening moats



Note: 1. Attach Rate is the percentage of total users that opt for AtherStack Pro

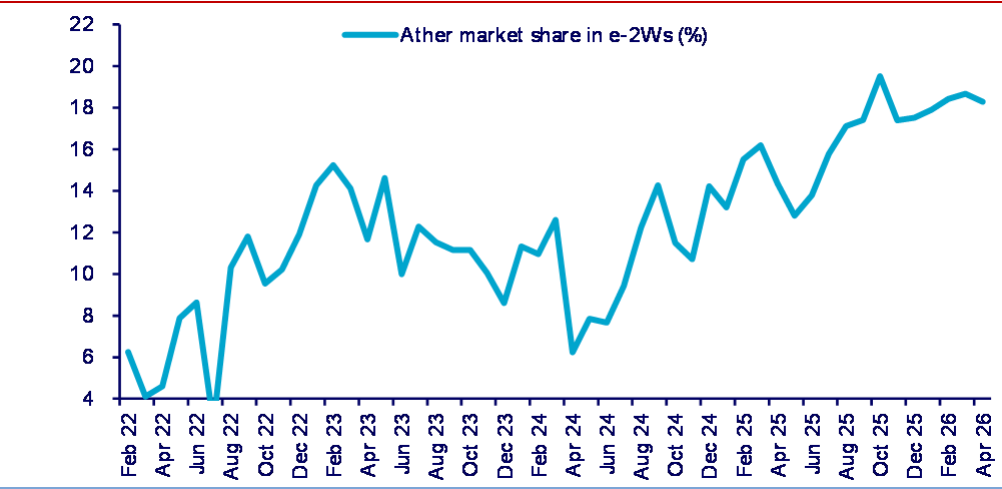
Source: Vahan Portal + Online Sales data from the official website of Information Technology, Electronics & Communication Department (IT E&C), Government Of Telangana

\*Excludes Telangana for Mar'26 as it was unavailable at the time of publishing

Source: Company

Figure 28

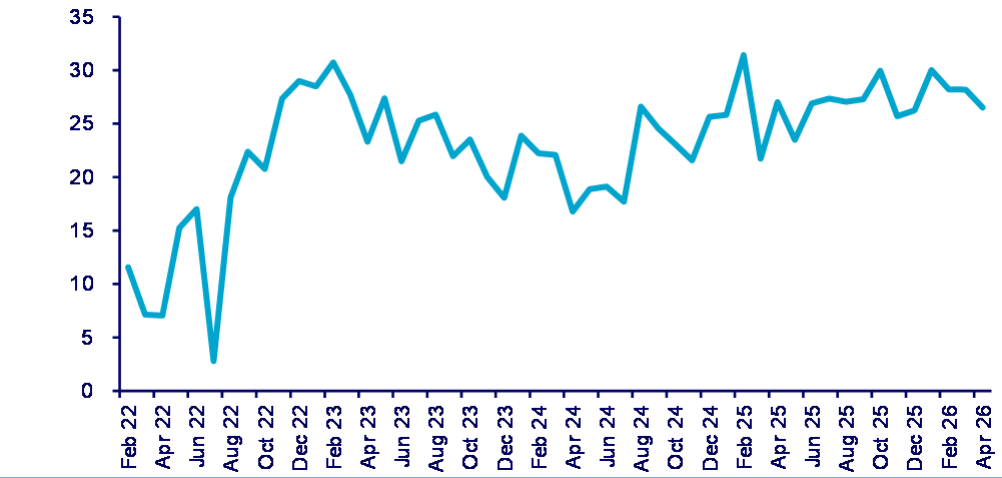
## Ather market share in India



Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 29

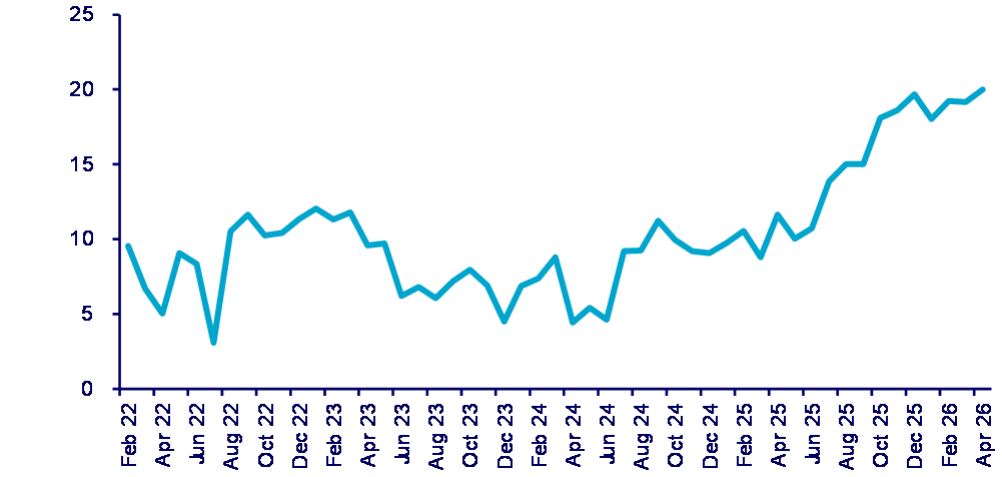
**Ather market share in Karnataka**



Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 30

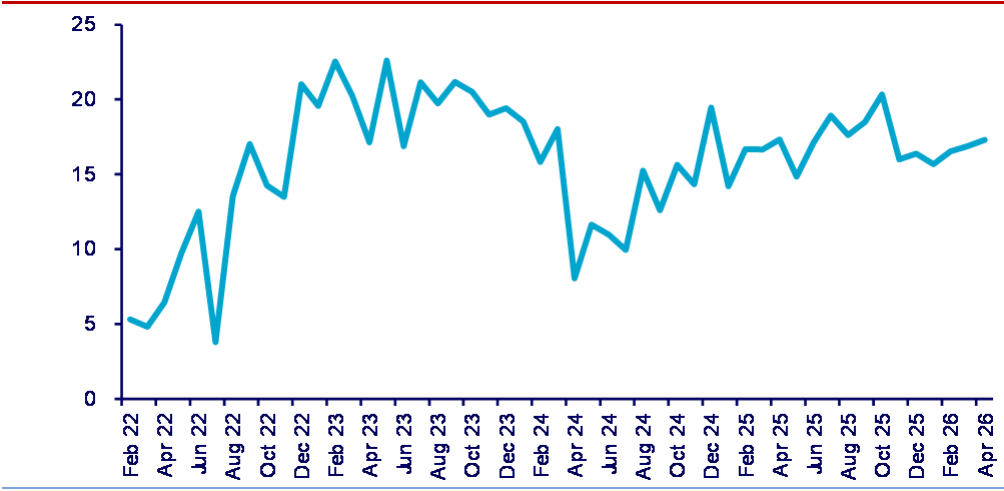
**Ather market share in Maharashtra**



Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 31

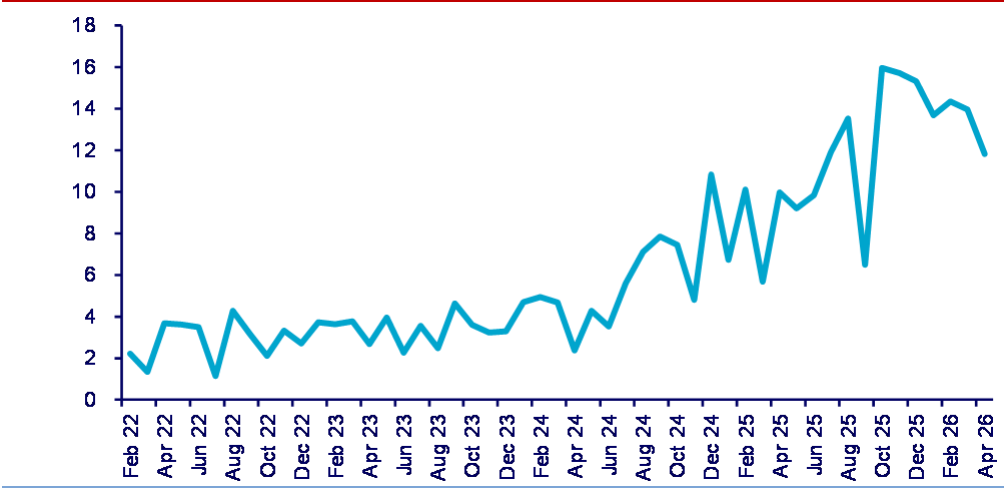
**Ather market share in Tamil Nadu**



Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 32

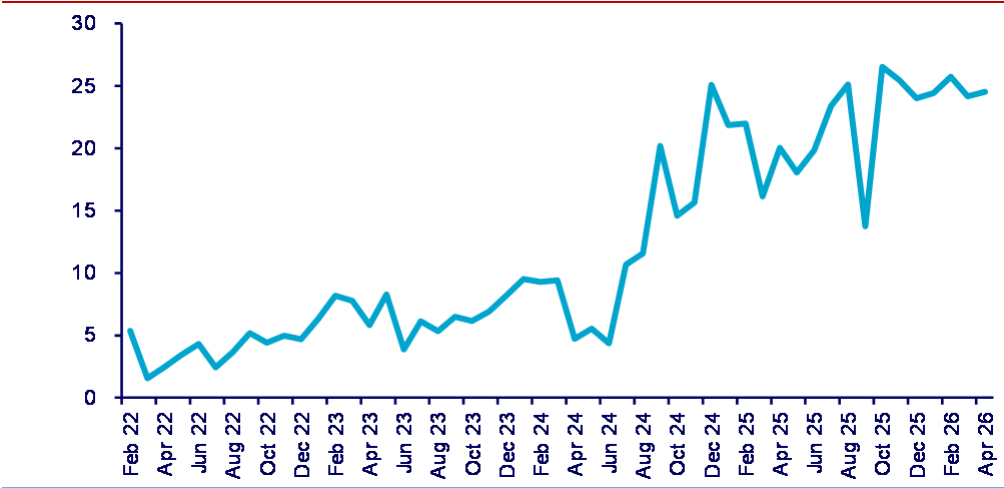
Ather market share in Rajasthan



Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 33

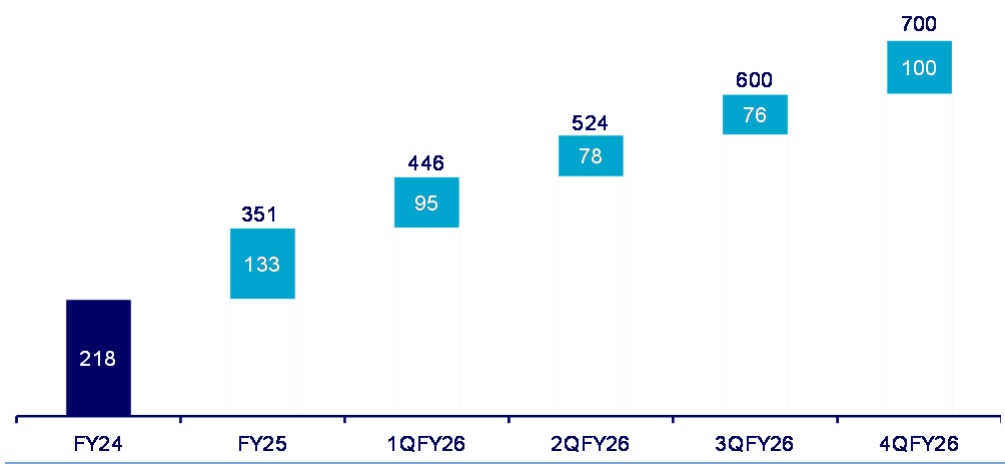
Ather market share in Gujarat



Source: Vahan, CLSA

Figure 34

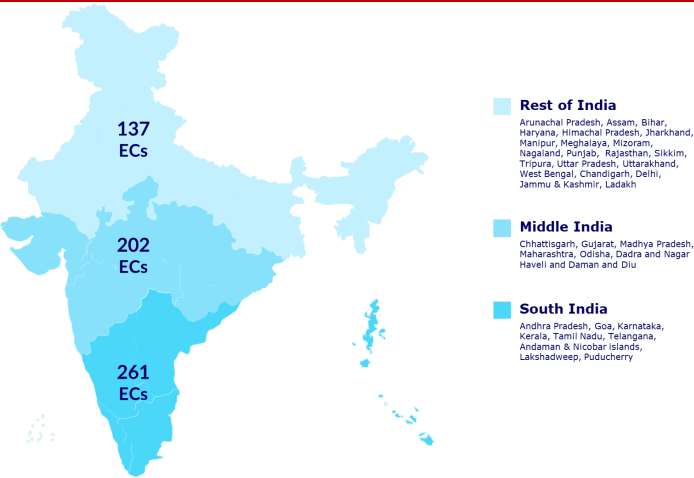
Ather's experience centre count



Source: Company, CLSA

Figure 35

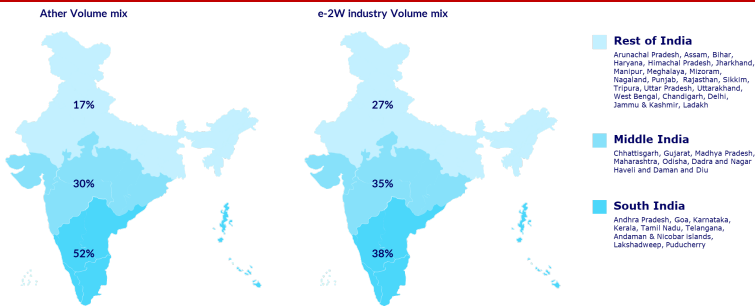
Zonal Footprint of Ather’s experience centre (experience centres (ECs))



Source: Company, CLSA

Figure 36

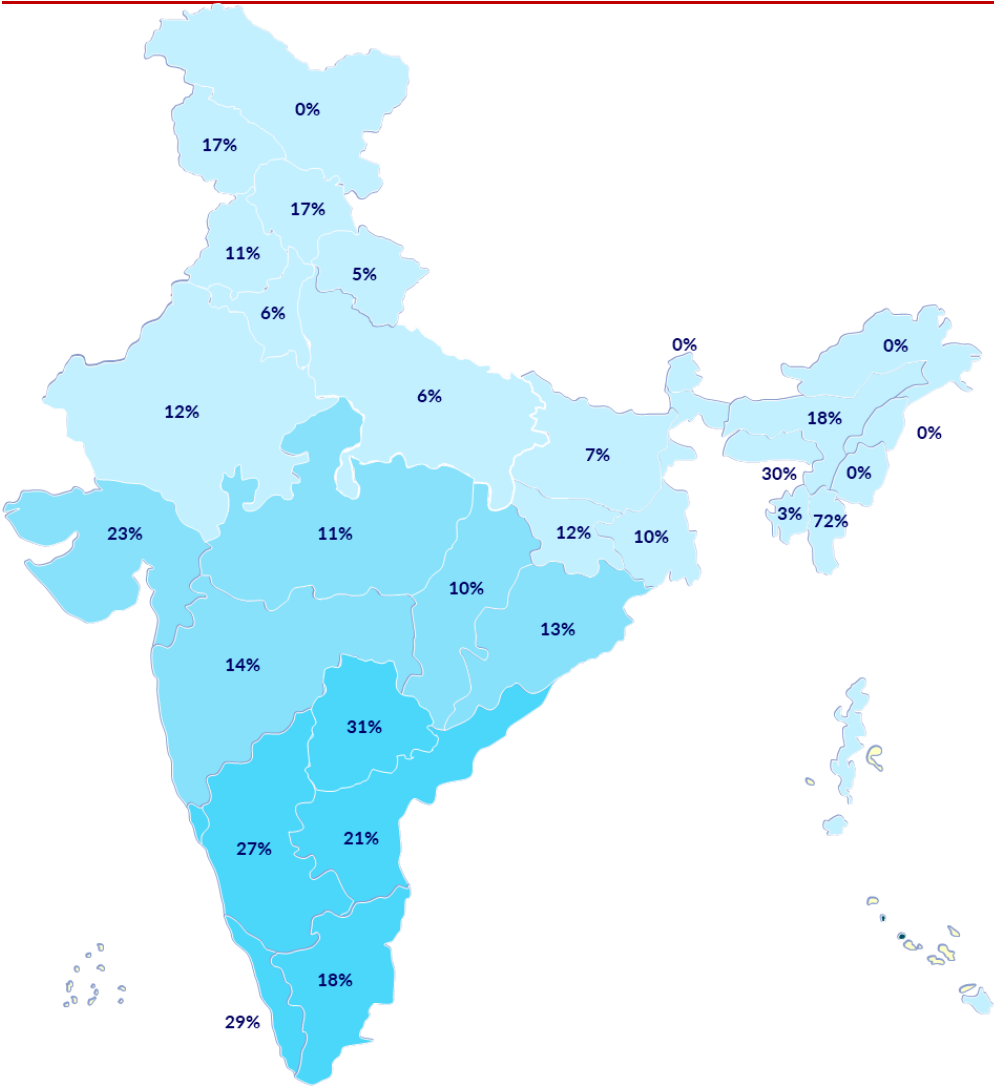
Ather’s volume mix in 9MFY26



Source: SIAM, Vahan, CLSA

Figure 37

Ather market share across states in 2025



Source: SIAM, Vahan, CLSA

Ather product portfolio

All New

Ather Rizta

Starting price ₹ 99 999

Or Flexipay ₹ 2 199/month

Book now

Explore Offers

Ather 450S

Starting price ₹ 119 999

Or Flexipay ₹ 2 475/month

Home test ride

Explore 450

Ather 450X

Starting price ₹ 1 46 999

Or Flexipay ₹ 2 789/month

Home test ride

Explore 450

Ather 450 Apex

Starting price ₹ 1 89 999

Or Flexipay ₹ 3 439/month

Home test ride

Explore 450 Apex

Source: Ather Energy

Figure 38

Ather gross margin trajectory (%)

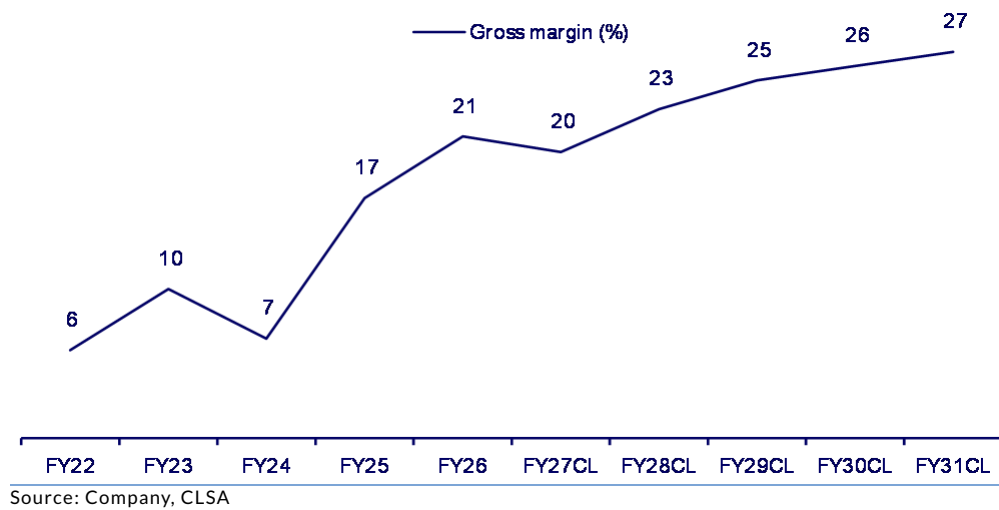


Figure 39

### Ather Ebitda margin trajectory

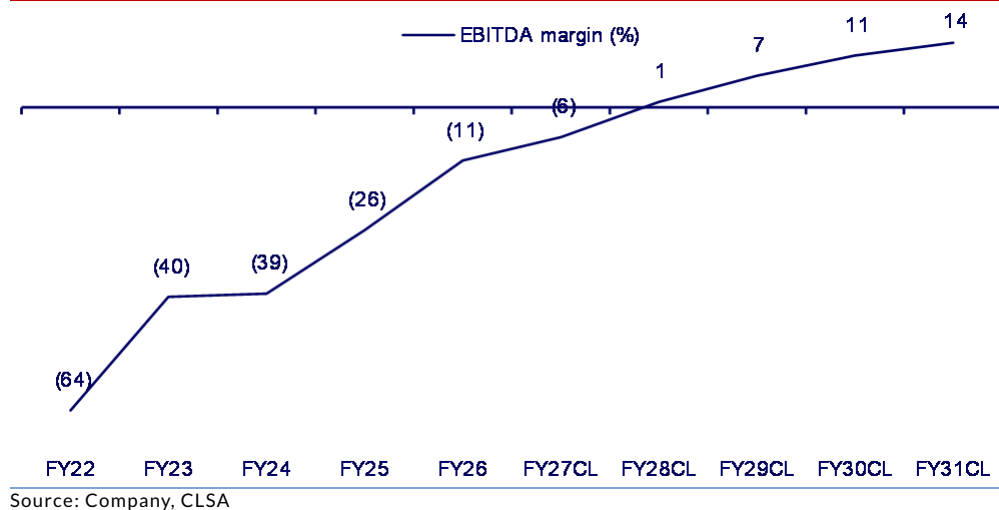
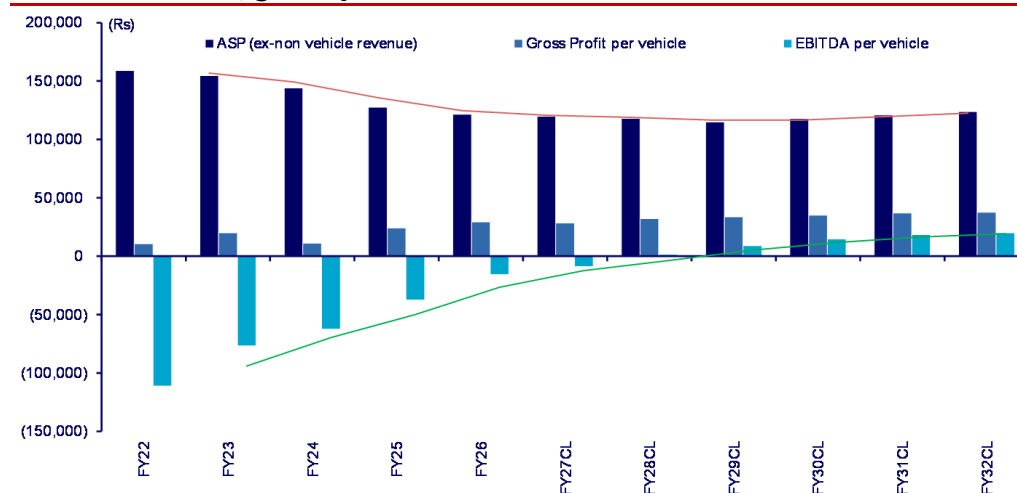


Figure 40

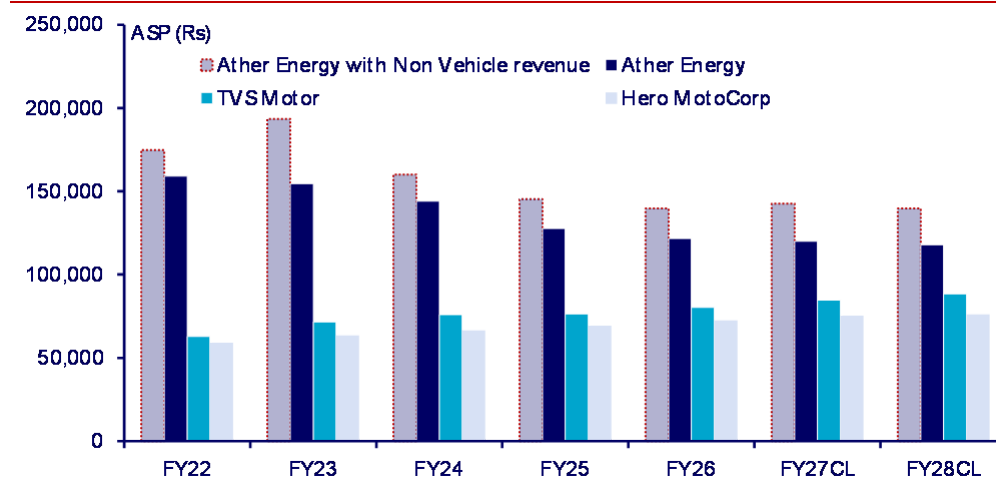
### Per vehicle ASP, gross profit and Ebitda



Ather has demonstrated a clear improvement in gross margin trajectory over the last several quarters, driven by sustained cost-optimisation initiatives, product re-engineering and rising scale. Over 3QFY26, the company reported a c.700bps YoY improvement in adjusted gross margin to c.25%, with Ebitda margin improving sharply, underscoring the impact of operating leverage and tighter cost control.

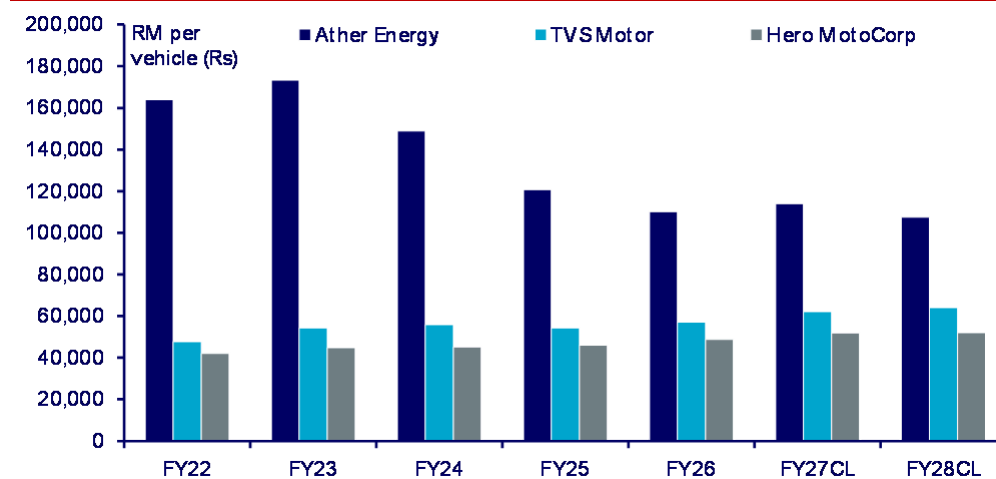


Figure 41

**ASP comparison**

Source: Company, Bajaj Auto, TVS Motor, Hero MotoCorp, CLSA; Note: We don't include Bajaj Auto because the share of 3Ws is higher in the product mix which inflates ASP

Figure 42

**Raw material per vehicle comparison**

Source: Company, Bajaj Auto, TVS Motor, Hero MotoCorp, CLSA

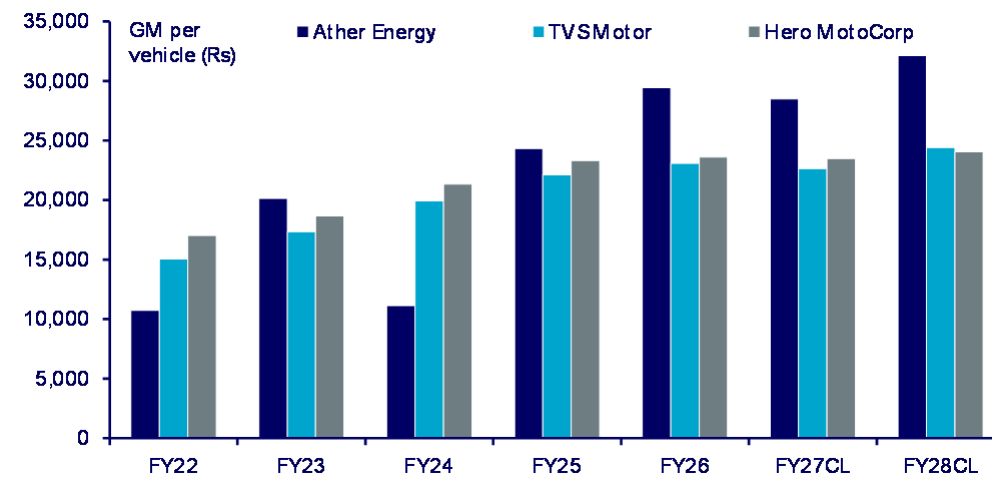
Gross margin improvement is on back of:

- bill-of-materials (BOM) reduction through localisation, supplier renegotiation and design simplification,
- manufacturing and process re-engineering, particularly across battery packs, power electronics and vehicle architecture, and
- better scale benefits from higher volumes driven primarily by the Rizta platform.

As a result, raw material cost per vehicle has declined sequentially, with cost of goods sold per unit falling meaningfully, despite commodity volatility.

Figure 43

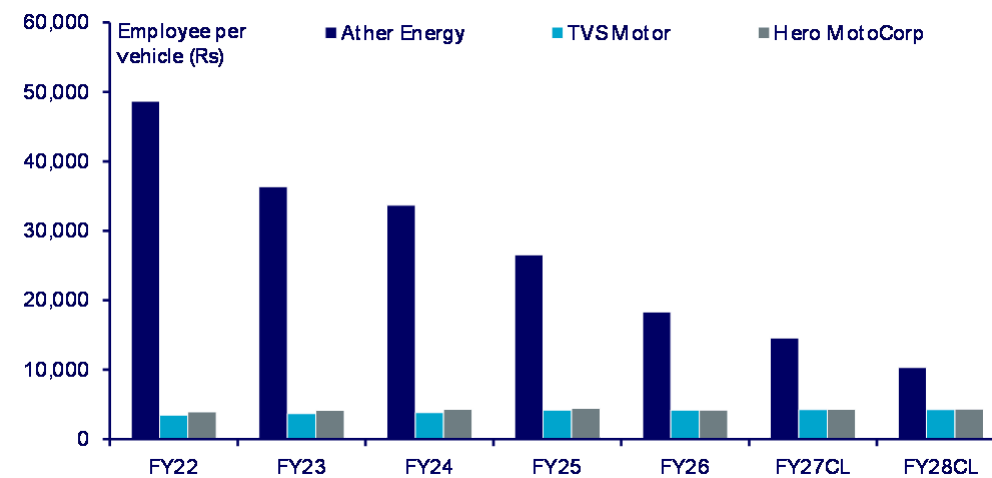
**Gross profit per vehicle comparison**



Source: Company, Bajaj Auto, TVS Motor, Hero MotoCorp, CLSA; Note: We don't include Bajaj Auto because the share of 3Ws is higher in the product mix which inflates gross profit/vehicle

Figure 44

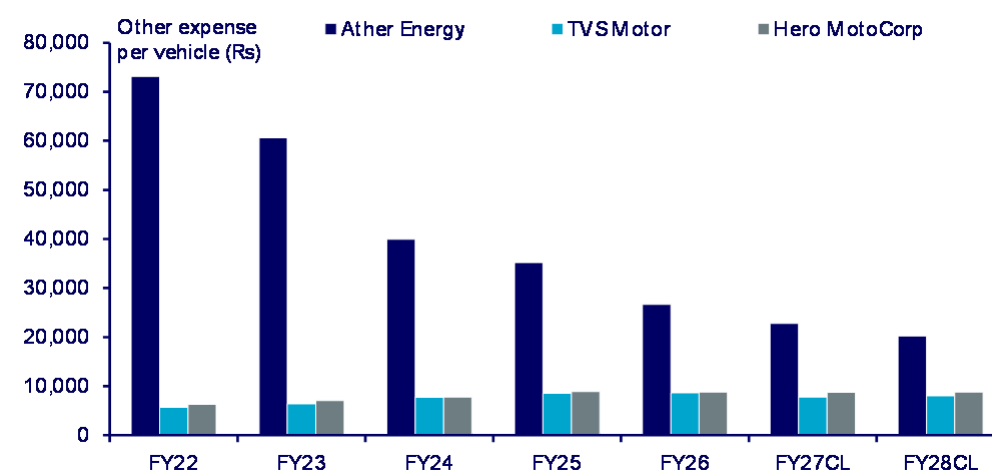
### Employee cost per vehicle comparison



Source: Company, Bajaj Auto, TVS Motor, Hero MotoCorp, CLSA

Figure 45

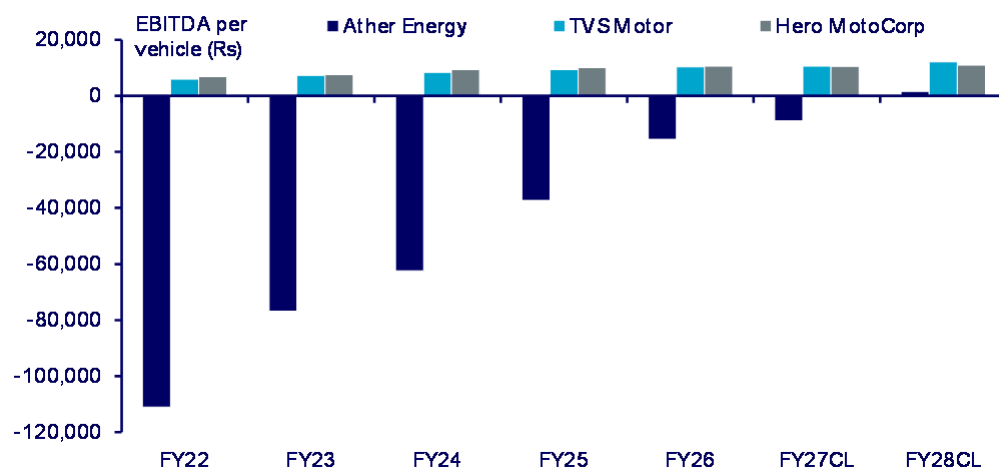
### Other expense per vehicle comparison



Source: Company, Bajaj Auto, TVS Motor, Hero MotoCorp, CLSA

Figure 46

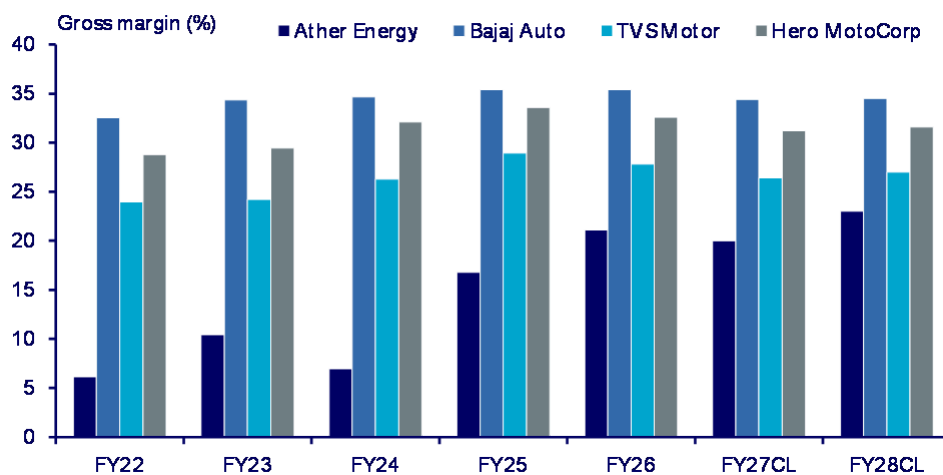
### Ebitda per vehicle comparison



Source: Company, Bajaj Auto, TVS Motor, Hero MotoCorp, CLSA

Figure 47

### Gross margin comparison



Source: Company, Bajaj Auto, TVS Motor, Hero MotoCorp, CLSA

On a per-unit cost basis, Ather's gross profit per vehicle is now converging towards levels seen at large ICE two-wheeler OEMs, adjusted for drivetrain differences, indicating that EV-specific components are no longer a structural disadvantage at scale.

However, employee costs and other operating expenses per vehicle remain significantly higher than mature 2W OEM benchmarks, reflecting:

- a relatively smaller installed base and lower absolute volume,
- higher fixed costs related to R&D, software development, and network expansion, and
- investment ahead of the curve in charging and service infrastructure.

This cost structure implies that incremental profitability is highly sensitive to volume growth, with material operating leverage potential as fixed costs are absorbed over a larger sales base.

Given the convergence in variable costs and improving gross margins, Ather's ability to reach peer-comparable profitability metrics (at an Ebitda and cash-flow level) hinges primarily on meaningful acceleration in e2W adoption.

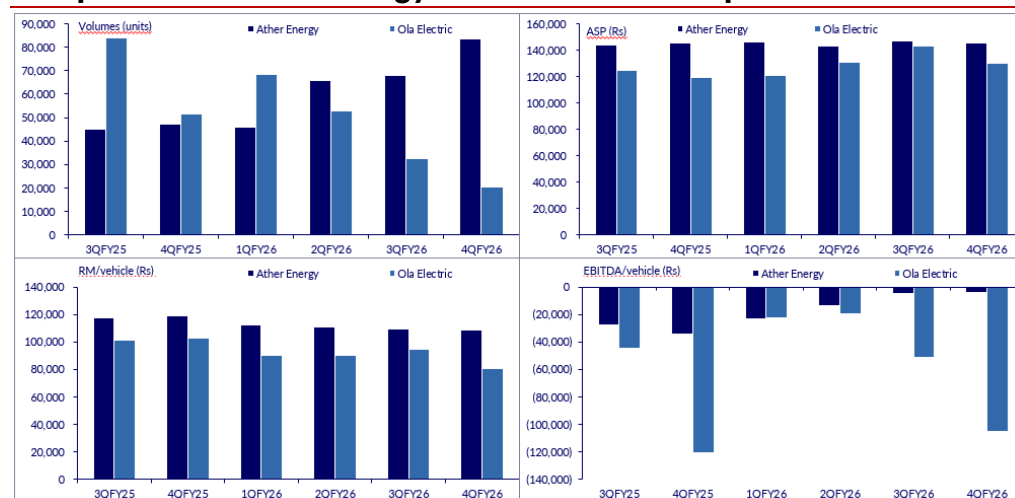
Ather has largely de-risked the EV gross margin narrative through cost optimisation and platform re-engineering, with the upcoming EL platform offering further upside. The remaining profitability gap versus incumbent 2W

OEMs is now predominantly a scale and adoption question, rather than a structural cost disadvantage.

### Comparison per unit between Ather and Ola Electric

Figure 48

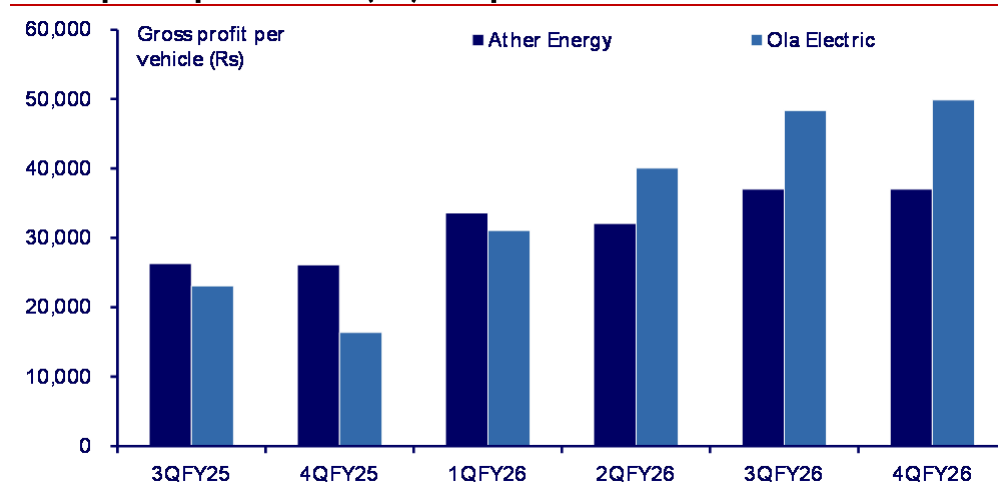
#### Comparison of Ather Energy and Ola Electric on per unit basis



Source: Company, Ola Electric, CLSA; Note: For both Ather and Ola ASP and Ebitda includes other income as reported by Ola; Ola numbers are for Automotive segment.

Figure 49

#### Gross profit per vehicle (Rs) comparison



Source: Company, Ola Electric, CLSA; Note: For both Ather and Ola includes other income as reported by Ola; Ola numbers are for Automotive segment.

### Ather does receive PLI incentives

Ather does not receive incentives under India's Auto Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme due to structural limitations in the scheme's original design and timing. When the Auto-PLI was launched in 2021, eligibility criteria were skewed toward large incumbent OEMs, requiring either global group revenues of over Rs100bn or, for new auto ancillaries, a minimum global net worth of Rs10bn as of March 2021. As a scaled-but-still-emerging pure-play EV OEM at the time, Ather did not meet these thresholds despite having in-house manufacturing, deep localisation, and a domestically developed EV platform. Compounding this, the scheme had a one-time application window that closed before Ather's volumes and revenues inflected, leaving no mechanism for later inclusion as the company scaled. While policymakers have since acknowledged that high-potential EV startups—particularly in electric two-wheelers—were inadvertently excluded and are evaluating reforms, Ather remains outside the PLI framework as of today, with management positioning this as reinforcing long-term pricing discipline and reducing reliance on policy-linked subsidies.

### Other e2W global peers

Globally, Gogoro has demonstrated that battery swapping can scale technologically, but its recent performance underscores the structural challenges of infrastructure-led EV models outside a tightly controlled home market like Taiwan: growth has slowed, losses have been significant, and international expansion has been curtailed as the company pivots toward cash preservation and an energy services focus. This contrasts sharply with Ather's path, which is deliberately product-led and aligned with India's existing policy and consumer ecosystem. By focusing on fixed-battery scooters, in-house manufacturing, and a premium-to-family product pipeline (450 series and Rizta), Ather has avoided the 'chicken and egg' problem inherent in swapping infrastructure, enabling steadier volume growth, clearer unit economics, and expansion funded primarily by vehicle sales rather than network capex. In effect, Gogoro validates the technical merits of swapping but highlights why, in the current Indian context, Ather's asset-lighter, product-centric strategy is better positioned to scale profitably and capture a broader consumer market.

NIU, despite being one of the earliest global leaders in connected electric scooters, has struggled to convert international expansion into sustained profitability, with growth slowing outside China amid weak dealer economics, limited brand resonance, and price-led competition eroding margins. Vmoto's experience has been similar: while it has achieved reasonable penetration in select European markets through OEM partnerships and fleet exposure, volume remain modest and profitability constrained by low differentiation and dependence on external distributors. Yadea, in contrast, has demonstrated strong scale advantages in China and emerging markets, but its success is largely driven by mass-market pricing, subsidy support, and manufacturing leverage—factors that are difficult to replicate in India's more brand and quality sensitive premium scooter segment. Collectively, these global peers highlight export-oriented or distributor-led EV models tend to face commoditisation and margin pressure when disconnected from local consumer insight and policy alignment. Ather's growth story stands apart in this context: its deep localisation, direct-to-consumer approach, premium positioning, and tight integration of hardware, software, and charging infrastructure have enabled more resilient demand and clearer unit economics.

## 5. Investment thesis

Ather Energy is a leading pure-play electric two-wheeler (e2W) maker in India, with an integrated business model spanning vehicle design and manufacturing, proprietary software, fast-charging infrastructure (Ather Grid) and after-sales service. The company operates in the premium and mass-family e2W segments through its 450 series and Rizta platforms, respectively, and has built strong brand equity around performance, safety and software-led differentiation.

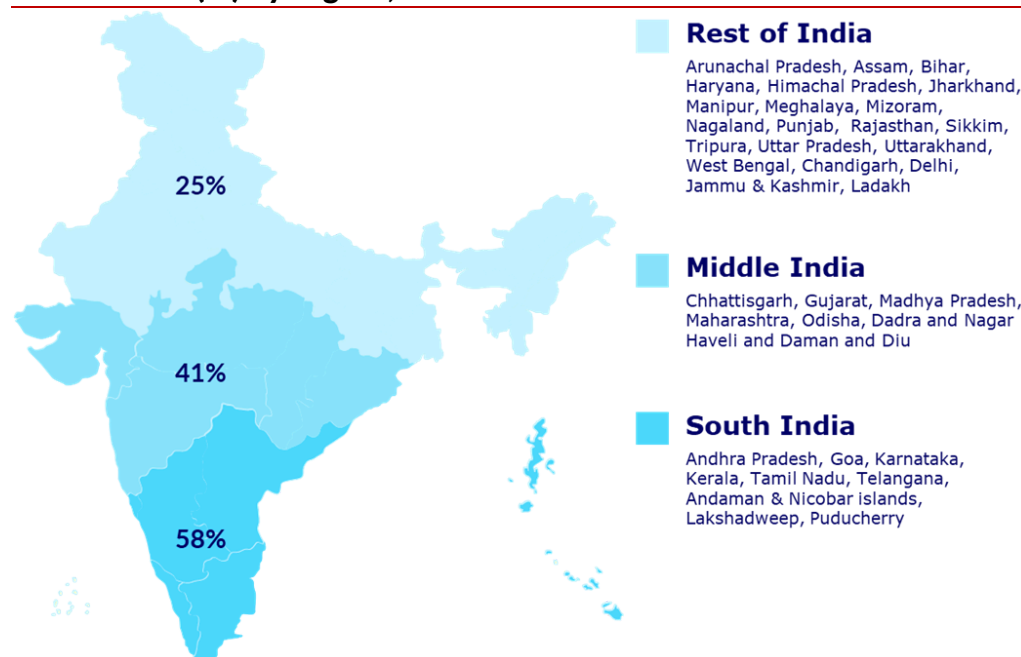
Ather has rapidly evolved into a scaled up, technology-led e2W platform, combining strong brand equity with deep in-house engineering application across vehicles, software and charging infrastructure. The successful launch of the Rizta has meaningfully expanded Ather's addressable market beyond premium users into the mass family scooter segment, driving sharp volume growth and market-share gains while preserving brand premia. Unlike most peers, Ather's vertically integrated AtherStack software (c.90%+ attach rate) and owned charging ecosystem create recurring revenue streams and superior unit economics, with non-vehicle income already forming a meaningful share of

revenues. Cost optimisation and re-engineering have improved gross margins materially, while raw material cost per vehicle is converging toward ICE 2W OEM levels; the remaining profitability gap is largely due to elevated fixed costs tied to R&D, software and network build-out. This sets up powerful operating leverage, further reinforced by the upcoming EL platform, which is designed to lower BOM costs and improve manufacturability at scale. With one of the strongest networks, a diversified portfolio, and a differentiated software moat, Ather is uniquely positioned to translate accelerating e2W adoption into rapid margin expansion and peer-level profitability as the category scales.

Ather has executed a clear, phased geographic expansion strategy, starting with South India, a region with the highest scooter penetration (58% in 2025), where its performance-oriented 450 portfolio—and more recently the family-focused Rizta—has helped it build market-leading positions (24% market share in 2025) in states such as Karnataka, Kerala, Telangana and Goa. Having firmly established itself in the south, Ather is now scaling rapidly across Central and Western India, the second-largest scooter markets (41% scooter mix) after the south, led by the acceptance of the Rizta. Accelerated store roll-outs and rising market share (Ather market share in region is 14%) in Gujarat, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan underscore the strength of execution in these regions. In contrast, North India remains structurally skewed towards entry-level and executive motorcycles (Scooter penetration at only 25%), driven by price-sensitive consumers prioritising lower upfront and running costs. Ather has indicated that this market will be addressed over time through products built on the upcoming EL platform, though management has clearly reiterated that even EL-based offerings will be priced above Rs100k, reinforcing Ather's disciplined positioning around value, technology and margins rather than chasing ultra-budget volumes.

Figure 50

### Scooter mix (%) by region, 2025



Source: SIAM, CLSA

We expect electric scooter adoption to accelerate sharply, with penetration rising from c.16% currently to c.50% by FY31, driven by rapidly improving charging density, lower-priced (but credible) product offerings, increasing confidence around durability versus ICE scooters, and the emergence of stable resale values. Against this backdrop, we believe Ather can scale its e2W market

share from 18% currently to c.20% and, importantly, defend this position through continuous hardware innovation and software-led differentiation, even amid expected entry from Japanese OEMs. As a result, we forecast Ather's volumes to grow at c.40% Cagr over the next five years. However, with the portfolio likely to see the addition of relatively more affordable models, we expect ASP growth to remain broadly flattish, implying revenue growth will largely mirror volume growth. Crucially, profitability should inflect meaningfully, supported by structural Ebitda tailwinds from: sustained gross-margin expansion driven by ongoing re-engineering and the rollout of the EL platform, a continued increase in non-vehicle revenue helping in improving margins and operating leverage kicking-in with the commissioning of new manufacturing capacity, materially improving fixed-cost absorption as scale builds. Hence, we are building in Ebitda margin to drastically improve from negative 11.1% in FY26CL to 13.5% by FY31CL.

## 6. Valuation

### PE-based target price of Rs1,450

We initiate coverage of Ather with an Outperform rating and a PE-based target price of Rs1,450.

We value Ather at a 40× FY32CL PE, discounted back to FY28CL using cost of equity (COE), to reflect a steady-state earnings framework rather than early-stage volatility. We anchor our valuation to FY32CL EPS as we expect this period to represent normalised profitability, driven by adequate scale, higher capacity utilisation and Ebitda margins transitioning from startup levels to sustainable OEM-like norms. While Ather is likely to turn PBT positive by FY29CL, accumulated losses and deferred tax assets should shield cash taxes for several years. Based on our estimates, cash taxes begin only in FY32CL, making this the first clean earnings year.

We assign a 40× PE multiple, in line with one standard deviation above TVS Motor's 5-year average, reflecting our view Ather deserves a mature-OEM valuation rather than a startup discount as we value at FY32CL. This is supported by sustainable high double-digit volume growth beyond FY32CL, underpinned by secular e2W adoption, and strong execution capabilities demonstrated by disciplined geographic expansion, portfolio diversification and margin improvement, akin to TVS' proven operating playbook. Ather is evolving from a startup EV player into a scaled, execution-driven mobility OEM, warranting parity valuation with best-in-class 2W OEMs over the medium term.

Figure 51

### PE based target price discounted to FY28CL

| Valuation              |       |
|------------------------|-------|
| FY32CL EPS             | 60    |
| PE multiple (x)        | 40.0  |
| Risk free rate         | 7.0   |
| Risk premium           | 5.5   |
| Beta                   | 1.2   |
| COE                    | 13.6  |
| Target price (rounded) | 1,450 |
| Source: CLSA           |       |

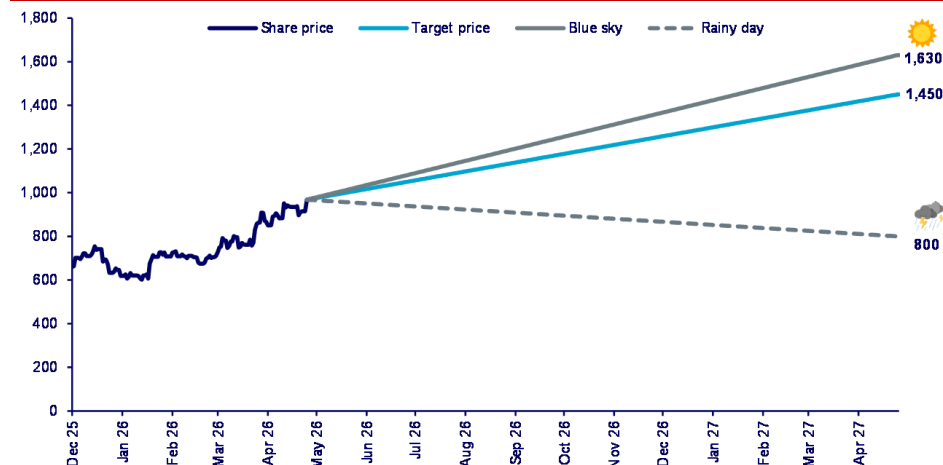
Figure 52

### Sensitivity to PE based target price and COE

|     |      | Sensitivity     |       |       |       |       |
|-----|------|-----------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
|     |      | PE Multiple (x) |       |       |       |       |
|     |      | 25.0            | 30.0  | 40.0  | 45.0  | 50.0  |
| COE | 12.5 | 940             | 1,130 | 1,510 | 1,690 | 1,880 |
| (%) | 13.0 | 920             | 1,110 | 1,480 | 1,660 | 1,850 |
|     | 13.6 | 910             | 1,090 | 1,450 | 1,630 | 1,810 |
|     | 14.0 | 890             | 1,070 | 1,430 | 1,610 | 1,780 |
|     | 14.5 | 880             | 1,050 | 1,400 | 1,580 | 1,750 |

Source: CLSA

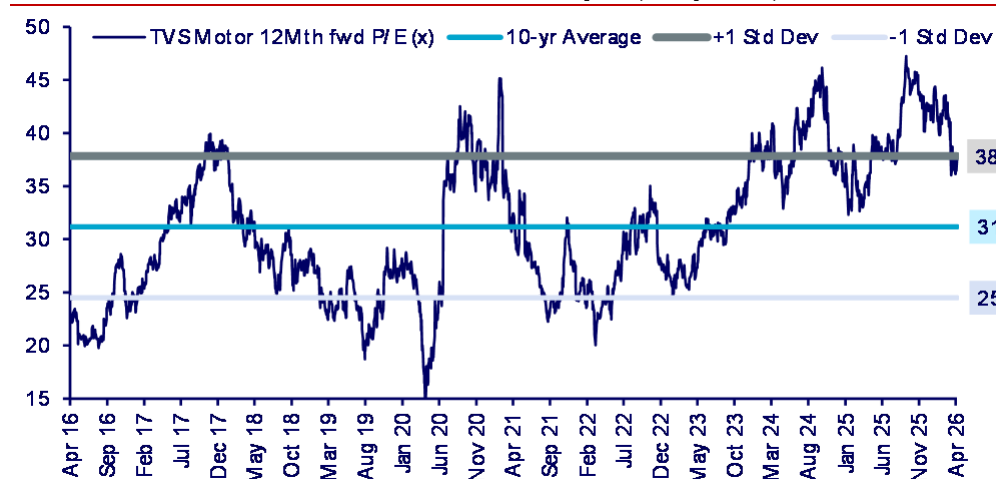
Figure 53

**Target price sensitivity (Rs)**

Source: Bloomberg, CLSA

We based our blue-sky value of Rs1,630 on a peak multiple PE of 45x which TVS has traded at. Similarly, our rainy-day fair value of Rs800 is based on 25x PE multiple which is in-line with -1 std. from the average multiple for TVS Motor and an Ebitda margin in the 13% range by FY32CL. Based on these assumption we believe Ather has favourable risk-reward.

Figure 54

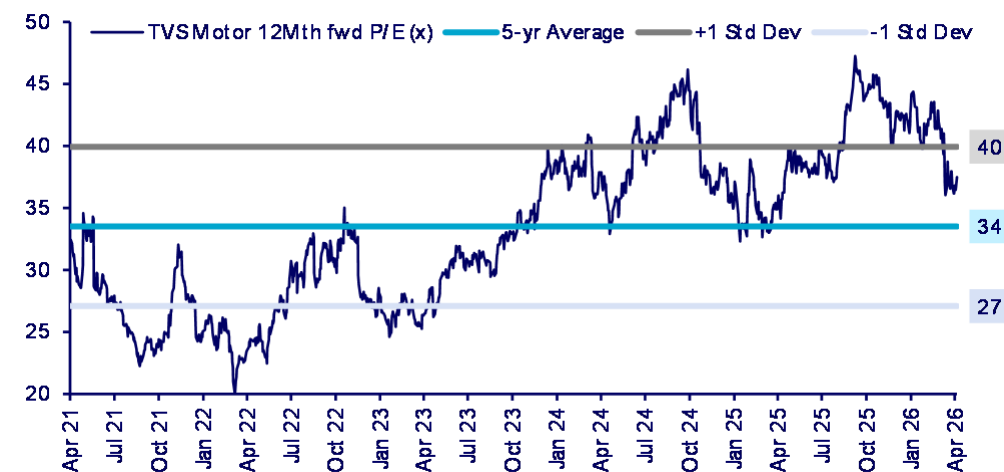
**TVS Motor 12-month forward PE multiple (10 years)**

Source: Refinitiv, CLSA

Figure 55

**TVS Motor 12-month forward PE multiple (5 years)**





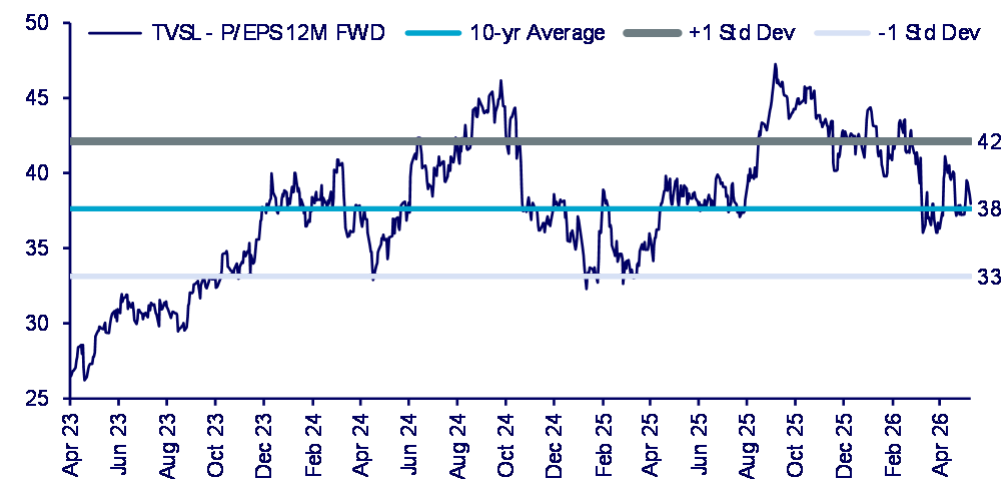
Source: Refinitiv, CLSA

### Why we see a 40x PE multiple as justified for Ather?

The assignment of a 40x PE multiple to Ather is best understood through the lens of historical precedence within the Indian 2W sector, particularly the rerating trajectory of TVS Motor. During its peak transformation phase (FY24–FY26), TVS traded at elevated multiples of c.40x, driven not by near-term earnings but by improving visibility on structural growth, premiumisation and margin expansion. The market effectively looked through cyclical headwinds and underwrote the company's continued volume outperformance versus industry. Crucially, this rerating occurred ahead of its full margin delivery, reflecting investor willingness to pay for the volume growth curve rather than current profitability.

Figure 56

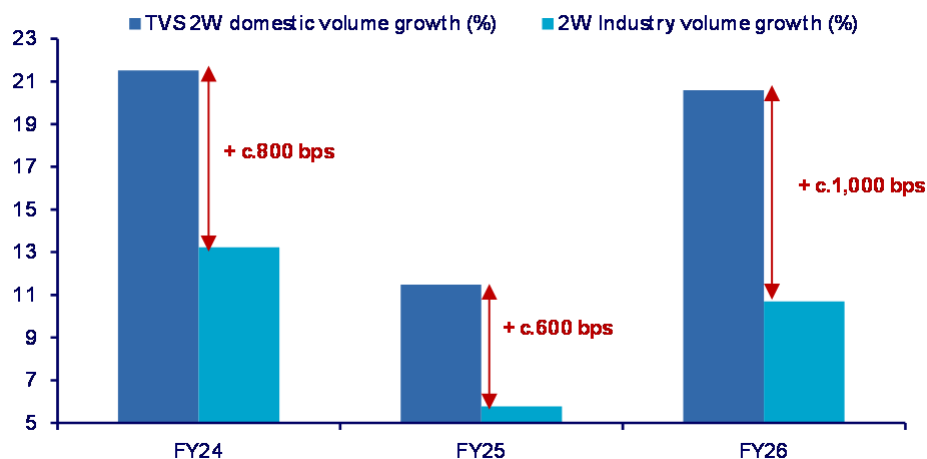
### TVS Motor 12-month forward PE multiple (3 years)



Source: Refinitiv, CLSA

Figure 57

### TVS Motor outperformance versus the industry

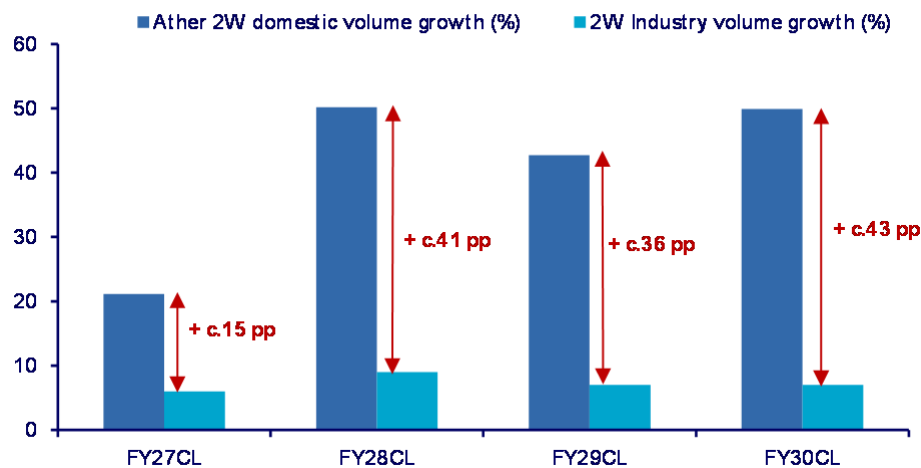


Source: TVS Motor

Ather today exhibits a comparable, if not more powerful, setup. Similar to TVS during its rerating, Ather is benefitting from a strong premiumisation cycle and improving visibility for both growth and margins. However, Ather's positioning extends beyond that of a traditional OEM. As a pure-play EV company operating in a segment seeing a c.40% Cagr, it is structurally better placed within an industry undergoing disruption rather than maturity. Moreover, Ather's integrated hardware-software ecosystem introduces an incremental monetisation layer that TVS did not possess during its early rerating phase. This combination of premium positioning, software-led differentiation, and platform-driven cost optimisation (via EL) creates a higher-quality and more scalable earnings profile.

Figure 58

### Ather outperformance versus industry growth

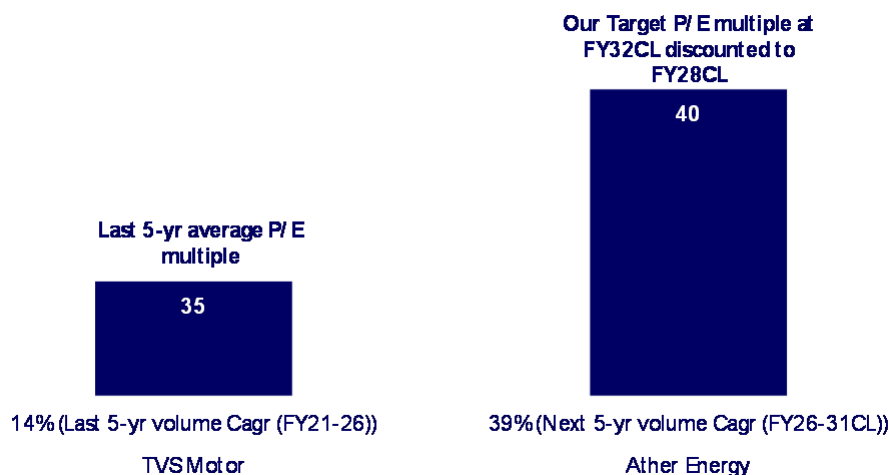


Source: CLSA

Importantly, the current phase of Ather's evolution mirrors the point at which TVS began to see multiple expansion—where gross profitability was improving, but Ebitda margins had yet to fully reflect operating leverage. Ather's unit economics are already converging with ICE peers on a gross profit per vehicle basis, implying the remaining profitability gap is largely a function of scale. As volume ramps-up and cost efficiency from the EL platform materialises, operating leverage is expected to drive a sharp inflection in margins. This visibility on margin expansion, coupled with strong industry tailwinds, supports the case for a premium valuation.

Figure 59

### Comparing with TVS Motor



Source: TVS Motor, Bloomberg, CLSA

In this context, we believe a 40x PE multiple is not only justified but also consistent with historical sector benchmarks for companies undergoing structural transformation. If anything, Ather's positioning as a premium, software-enabled EV platform warrants valuation parity, if not a premium, to legacy peers like TVS at similar stages of their growth cycle. The multiple, therefore, reflects the credibility of Ather's forward earnings trajectory, underpinned by premiumisation, electrification, and software-driven monetisation, rather than its near-term earnings base.

We also run a DCF-based valuation for Ather Energy, anchored to long-term structural assumptions for India's two-wheeler market. We assume a 2W industry Cagr of c.6% over FY26-50CL, with electric scooter penetration rising sharply from c.16% currently to c.90% by FY50CL, and electric motorcycle penetration increasing from a negligible base to c.35% over the same period. Backed by Ather's consistent execution track record and planned launches in more affordable segments, we build in moderate market share gains from c.18% currently to c.20% over the long term. This translates into a 17% volume Cagr for Ather over FY26-50CL.

On pricing, while the introduction of more affordable scooters is likely to exert near-term pressure on ASPs, resulting in a 2% Cagr (inflation) for its ASP over the forecast period. Consequently, revenue growth in our DCF broadly mirrors volume growth at c.19% Cagr over FY26-50CL. Using a beta of 1.2, risk-free rate of 7.0% and equity risk premium of 5.5%, we derive a WACC of 13.6%. We have assumed Ather to remain net cash positive. Based on these assumptions, our DCF yields an implied valuation of Rs1,400 per share at FY28CL, reinforcing our bullish medium-to-long-term view on Ather's scalable and profitability-inflecting business model.

Figure 60

### DCF-based valuation for Ather

| (Rs mn)                | FY27CL     | FY28CL     | FY29CL     | FY30CL     | FY35CL     | FY40CL     | FY45CL     |
|------------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
| <b>Volumes (units)</b> |            |            |            |            |            |            |            |
| Domestic 2W industry   | 23,008,332 | 25,079,082 | 26,834,618 | 28,713,041 | 39,588,257 | 55,344,961 | 75,827,393 |
| % YoY                  | 6.0%       | 9.0%       | 7.0%       | 7.0%       | 6.9%       | 6.9%       | 6.5%       |
| Motorcycle volumes     | 13,804,999 | 14,796,659 | 15,564,079 | 16,366,434 | 21,534,115 | 28,817,504 | 39,482,478 |
| % YoY                  | 5.7%       | 7.2%       | 5.2%       | 5.2%       | 6.0%       | 6.0%       | 6.5%       |
| Scooter volumes        | 8,743,166  | 9,780,842  | 10,733,847 | 11,772,347 | 18,054,141 | 26,527,457 | 36,344,915 |
| % YoY                  | 7.7%       | 11.9%      | 9.7%       | 9.7%       | 8.0%       | 8.0%       | 6.5%       |
| Mix (%)                |            |            |            |            |            |            |            |

|                               |                |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
|-------------------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|
| Motorcycle                    | 60.0           | 59.0           | 58.0           | 57.0             | 54.4             | 52.1             | 52.1             |
| Scooter                       | 38.0           | 39.0           | 40.0           | 41.0             | 45.6             | 47.9             | 47.9             |
| <b>EV Volumes (units)</b>     |                |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| Motorcycle                    | 207,075        | 591,866        | 933,845        | 1,309,315        | 3,445,458        | 7,204,376        | 12,831,805       |
| Scooter                       | 1,573,770      | 2,151,785      | 3,220,154      | 4,708,939        | 13,089,252       | 22,548,338       | 32,710,423       |
| <b>EV Adoption (%)</b>        |                |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| Motorcycle                    | 1.5%           | 4.0%           | 6.0%           | 8.0%             | 16.0%            | 25.0%            | 32.5%            |
| Scooter                       | 18.0%          | 22.0%          | 30.0%          | 40.0%            | 72.5%            | 85.0%            | 90.0%            |
| <b>Ather Market share (%)</b> |                |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| Motorcycle                    | 0.0%           | 0.0%           | 0.0%           | 2.0%             | 12.0%            | 15.5%            | 15.5%            |
| Scooter                       | 20.0%          | 22.0%          | 21.0%          | 21.0%            | 20.0%            | 20.0%            | 20.0%            |
| <b>Ather Domestic Volumes</b> | <b>314,754</b> | <b>473,393</b> | <b>676,232</b> | <b>1,015,063</b> | <b>3,031,306</b> | <b>5,626,346</b> | <b>8,531,014</b> |
| % YoY                         | 21.0%          | 50.4%          | 42.8%          | 50.1%            | 15.5%            | 11.8%            | 8.6%             |
| <b>Exports</b>                | <b>3,734</b>   | <b>4,854</b>   | <b>6,310</b>   | <b>8,203</b>     | <b>30,456</b>    | <b>113,081</b>   | <b>419,864</b>   |
| % YoY                         | 30.0%          | 30.0%          | 30.0%          | 30.0%            | 30.0%            | 30.0%            | 30.0%            |
| ASP                           | 120,000        | 118,000        | 115,000        | 118,000          | 133,506          | 151,050          | 165,954          |
| % YoY                         | -1.2%          | -1.7%          | -2.5%          | 2.6%             | 2.5%             | 2.5%             | 1.5%             |
| Vehicle Revenue               | 38,219         | 56,433         | 78,492         | 120,745          | 408,764          | 866,940          | 1,485,433        |
| % YoY                         | 19.6%          | 47.7%          | 39.1%          | 53.8%            | 18.5%            | 14.9%            | 11.1%            |
| Non-Vehicle revenue           | 7,160          | 10,382         | 14,016         | 17,519           | 53,465           | 133,038          | 304,030          |
| % YoY                         | 50.0%          | 45.0%          | 35.0%          | 25.0%            | 25.0%            | 20.0%            | 15.0%            |
| <b>Revenues</b>               | <b>45,378</b>  | <b>66,815</b>  | <b>92,508</b>  | <b>138,265</b>   | <b>462,229</b>   | <b>999,979</b>   | <b>1,789,463</b> |
| Ebitda per vehicle            | (8,862)        | 1,585          | 9,009          | 14,682           | 21,945           | 25,440           | 29,205           |
| Ebitda                        | (2,822)        | 758            | 6,149          | 15,024           | 67,189           | 146,009          | 261,413          |
| <b>Ebitda margin (%)</b>      | <b>-6.2%</b>   | <b>1.1%</b>    | <b>6.6%</b>    | <b>10.9%</b>     | <b>14.5%</b>     | <b>14.6%</b>     | <b>14.6%</b>     |
| Depreciation                  | 2,321          | 3,913          | 4,450          | 5,360            | 11,542           | 17,213           | 20,020           |
| EBIT                          | (5,143)        | (3,154)        | 1,699          | 9,664            | 55,647           | 128,796          | 241,393          |
| Tax expense                   | -              | -              | 425            | 2,416            | 13,912           | 32,199           | 60,348           |
| EBI                           | (5,143)        | (3,154)        | 1,274          | 7,248            | 41,735           | 96,597           | 181,045          |
| EBI + Depreciation            | (2,822)        | 758            | 5,724          | 12,608           | 53,277           | 113,810          | 201,065          |
| Capex                         | 5,200          | 5,700          | 5,700          | 6,500            | 12,000           | 5,000            | 23,263           |
| Change in working capital     | 1,606          | 2,719          | 3,238          | 5,660            | 12,174           | 11,000           | 1,789            |
| <b>FCF</b>                    | <b>(6,416)</b> | <b>(2,223)</b> | <b>3,262</b>   | <b>11,768</b>    | <b>53,451</b>    | <b>119,810</b>   | <b>179,591</b>   |
| <b>Discounted FCF</b>         | <b>(6,416)</b> | <b>(1,956)</b> | <b>2,528</b>   | <b>8,028</b>     | <b>19,272</b>    | <b>22,834</b>    | <b>18,092</b>    |
| Risk free rate                | 7.0            |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| Risk premium                  | 5.5            |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| Beta                          | 1.2            |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| <b>WACC</b>                   | <b>13.6</b>    |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| Sum of discounted FCF         | 365,116        |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| Net cash - March 2027         | 13,937         |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| Terminal growth               | 5.0            |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| Terminal value                | 157,060        |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| <b>Equity value (Rs mn)</b>   | <b>536,113</b> |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| No. of Shares (mn)            | 384            |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |
| <b>Equity value per share</b> | <b>1,400</b>   |                |                |                  |                  |                  |                  |

Source: Company, CLSA

Figure 61

## Sensitivity to terminal growth and WACC

|          |      | Sensitivity         |       |       |       |       |
|----------|------|---------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
|          |      | Terminal growth (%) |       |       |       |       |
|          |      | 4.0                 | 4.5   | 5.0   | 5.5   | 6.0   |
| WACC (%) | 12.5 | 1,630               | 1,670 | 1,710 | 1,750 | 1,800 |
|          | 13.0 | 1,490               | 1,520 | 1,550 | 1,590 | 1,630 |
|          | 13.6 | 1,350               | 1,370 | 1,400 | 1,420 | 1,450 |
|          | 14.0 | 1,270               | 1,280 | 1,310 | 1,330 | 1,350 |
|          | 14.5 | 1,170               | 1,190 | 1,200 | 1,220 | 1,240 |

Source: CLSA

Figure 62

## Target price (Rs): comparison of our PE-based target price and secondary DCF valuation

### Target price (Rs)

|                                |       |
|--------------------------------|-------|
| PE multiple based target price | 1,450 |
| DCF based implied valuation    | 1,400 |

Source: CLSA

Our valuation is anchored to a PE multiple. Our DCF analysis is used only as a secondary framework—to cross-check the reasonableness of implied growth, margin, and capital efficiency assumptions embedded in our PE-based valuation.

Figure 63

## Valuation comparison of peers

|                     | Price      | Mcap       | EPS (Rs)      |              | P/Sales (%) |            | PE (x)    |           |
|---------------------|------------|------------|---------------|--------------|-------------|------------|-----------|-----------|
|                     | (Rs)       | (US\$b)    | 27CL          | 28CL         | 27CL        | 28CL       | 27CL      | 28CL      |
| Bajaj Auto          | 10,463     | 29.4       | 418.6         | 471.0        | 4.1         | 3.7        | 25.0      | 22.2      |
| Eicher Motor        | 6,852      | 19.5       | 216.2         | 257.1        | 8.6         | 7.5        | 31.7      | 26.6      |
| Hero MotoCorp       | 4,963      | 10.3       | 271.3         | 297.8        | 1.9         | 1.8        | 18.3      | 16.7      |
| TVS Motors          | 3,365      | 16.1       | 90.2          | 115.8        | 3.0         | 2.6        | 37.3      | 29.0      |
| <b>Ather Energy</b> | <b>909</b> | <b>3.6</b> | <b>(13.0)</b> | <b>(9.1)</b> | <b>7.7</b>  | <b>8.4</b> | <b>NM</b> | <b>NM</b> |
| Ola Electric (N-R)  | 31         | 1.5        | (3.4)         | (3.3)        | 4.0         | 3.2        | NM        | NM        |

Source: CLSA, Bloomberg

Figure 64

## Sensitivity of fair value to EV adoption rate and PE

|                        | Sensitivity |                 |       |       |       |       |
|------------------------|-------------|-----------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
|                        | FY32CL      | PE Multiple (x) |       |       |       |       |
|                        |             | 20.0            | 25.0  | 30.0  | 35.0  | 40.0  |
| EV Adoption in 2Ws (%) | 15          | 300             | 370   | 440   | 520   | 590   |
|                        | 20          | 430             | 540   | 650   | 750   | 860   |
|                        | 25          | 550             | 690   | 830   | 970   | 1,110 |
|                        | 31          | 720             | 900   | 1,080 | 1,270 | 1,450 |
|                        | 35          | 820             | 1,020 | 1,230 | 1,430 | 1,640 |
|                        | 40          | 950             | 1,180 | 1,420 | 1,660 | 1,900 |
|                        | 50          | 1,180           | 1,480 | 1,780 | 2,070 | 2,370 |

Source: CLSA

We build in EV penetration of c.30% by FY32CL, led by stronger adoption in scooters (c.60%) and relatively lower penetration in motorcycles (c.10%).

To account for forecast uncertainty, we present a sensitivity of EV adoption rates to valuation, with varying penetration assumptions driving changes in the implied PE multiple and, in turn, our target price.

## Ather is a 2x 3-year story

We see Ather as well positioned to deliver c.2x returns over the next three years. Our valuation is based on a 40x FY32CL EPS multiple, discounted back to FY30CL, resulting in a three-year forward fair value of Rs1,870, compared to the current market price of c.Rs910.

This implies c.100% upside, underpinned by strong volume scaling, improving profitability and a structural shift towards EV adoption, positioning Ather as a potential “doubler” over the medium term.

Figure 65

### We believe Ather can double in three years

|                               | (Rs)  |
|-------------------------------|-------|
| 1-year forward fair value     | 1,450 |
| 2-year forward fair value     | 1,640 |
| 3-year forward fair value     | 1,870 |
| Current market price          | 910   |
| Implied upside in three years | 105%  |

Source: CLSA

We view Ather as a medium-term (3-year) investment story rather than a near-term trade. Backed by a differentiated product portfolio, its in-house developed Ather Stack, and feature-rich offerings in the e2W segment, we believe Ather is well positioned to maintain its market share.

On the profitability front, scale remains the key catalyst. As volume ramps-up, we expect operating leverage to steadily play out, driving improvements in per-vehicle profitability. Over time, this should enable Ather's margins to converge closer to those of established 2W OEMs, supporting a more sustainable earnings profile.

## 7. Financials

Figure 66

### Ather profit and loss statement

| (Rs mn)                    | FY24            | FY25           | FY26           | FY27CL         | FY28CL         | FY29CL        | FY30CL         | FY31CL         | FY32CL         |
|----------------------------|-----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|---------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| <b>Net Sales</b>           | <b>17,538</b>   | <b>22,550</b>  | <b>36,718</b>  | <b>45,378</b>  | <b>66,815</b>  | <b>92,508</b> | <b>138,265</b> | <b>186,750</b> | <b>250,594</b> |
| Raw Materials              | 15,792          | 18,269         | 28,082         | 36,303         | 51,448         | 69,381        | 102,316        | 136,327        | 182,934        |
| Stock Adjustments          | (526)           | (499)          | (895)          |                |                |               |                |                |                |
| Gross Profit               | 1,220           | 3,782          | 7,742          | 9,076          | 15,367         | 23,127        | 35,949         | 50,422         | 67,660         |
| Employee Cost              | 3,692           | 4,124          | 4,816          | 4,638          | 4,921          | 5,877         | 7,098          | 8,352          | 10,024         |
| Other Expense              | 4,375           | 5,467          | 7,009          | 7,261          | 9,688          | 11,101        | 13,826         | 16,807         | 21,300         |
| <b>Ebitda</b>              | <b>(6,847)</b>  | <b>(5,809)</b> | <b>(4,084)</b> | <b>(2,822)</b> | <b>758</b>     | <b>6,149</b>  | <b>15,024</b>  | <b>25,263</b>  | <b>36,335</b>  |
| Other Income               | 353             | 502            | 1,513          | 950            | 440            | 500           | 1,000          | 2,000          | 3,000          |
| Interest                   | 890             | 1,106          | 822            | 832            | 832            | 832           | 832            | 832            | 832            |
| Depreciation               | 1,467           | 1,710          | 1,729          | 2,321          | 3,913          | 4,450         | 5,360          | 6,340          | 6,862          |
| Profit Before Tax          | (8,851)         | (8,123)        | (5,121)        | (5,025)        | (3,546)        | 1,367         | 9,832          | 20,091         | 31,642         |
| Tax                        | -               | -              | -              | -              | -              | -             | -              | -              | 7,910          |
| Reported Net Profit        | (8,851)         | (8,123)        | (5,121)        | (5,025)        | (3,546)        | 1,367         | 9,832          | 20,091         | 23,731         |
| Extraordinary Items        | 1,746           | -              | 50             | -              | -              | -             | -              | -              | -              |
| <b>Adjusted Net Profit</b> | <b>(10,597)</b> | <b>(8,123)</b> | <b>(5,172)</b> | <b>(5,025)</b> | <b>(3,546)</b> | <b>1,367</b>  | <b>9,832</b>   | <b>20,091</b>  | <b>23,731</b>  |
| <b>EPS</b>                 | <b>(47)</b>     | <b>(32)</b>    | <b>(14)</b>    | <b>(13)</b>    | <b>(9)</b>     | <b>4</b>      | <b>25</b>      | <b>51</b>      | <b>60</b>      |
| <b>Ratios (%)</b>          |                 |                |                |                |                |               |                |                |                |
| Gross Profit Margin (%)    | 7.0             | 16.8           | 21.1           | 20.0           | 23.0           | 25.0          | 26.0           | 27.0           | 27.0           |
| Employee cost (%)          | 21.1            | 18.3           | 13.1           | 10.2           | 7.4            | 6.4           | 5.1            | 4.5            | 4.0            |
| Other expense (%)          | 24.9            | 24.2           | 19.1           | 16.0           | 14.5           | 12.0          | 10.0           | 9.0            | 8.5            |
| <b>Ebitda Margin (%)</b>   | <b>(39.0)</b>   | <b>(25.8)</b>  | <b>(11.1)</b>  | <b>(6.2)</b>   | <b>1.1</b>     | <b>6.6</b>    | <b>10.9</b>    | <b>13.5</b>    | <b>14.5</b>    |

Source: Company, CLSA

Ather has been consistently improving its gross margin, driven by product re-engineering initiatives and a decline in key input costs, particularly lithium-ion battery prices. We believe further margin expansion will be

supported by the introduction of LFP batteries, continued growth in higher-margin non-vehicle revenues, and the launch of the new EL platform, which should structurally improve cost efficiency. Accordingly, we build in gross margins to improve from 21% in FY26CL to 27% by FY31CL. Additionally, as operating scale improves, we expect operating leverage to accrue meaningfully, leading to an expansion in Ebitda margins from the current -11.1% to 14.5% by FY32CL, broadly in line with established 2W OEMs, such as TVS Motor.

Figure 67

### Ather balance sheet

|                                        | FY24          | FY25          | FY26          | FY27CL        | FY28CL        | FY29CL        | FY30CL        | FY31CL         | FY32CL         |
|----------------------------------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|----------------|----------------|
| PPE and Capital work in progress       | 5,295         | 7,380         | 9,676         | 12,555        | 14,342        | 15,592        | 16,732        | 17,393         | 18,031         |
| Other financial assets                 | 153           | 333           | 448           | 448           | 448           | 448           | 448           | 448            | 448            |
| Other non-current assets               | 1393          | 1725          | 3342          | 3510          | 3685          | 3869          | 4063          | 4266           | 4479           |
| <b>Total - non-current assets</b>      | <b>6,841</b>  | <b>9,438</b>  | <b>13,466</b> | <b>16,512</b> | <b>18,475</b> | <b>19,910</b> | <b>21,243</b> | <b>22,107</b>  | <b>22,958</b>  |
| Inventories                            | 1,167         | 2,446         | 2,816         | 3,730         | 5,492         | 7,603         | 11,364        | 15,349         | 20,597         |
| Investments                            | 2,922         | 410           | 5,520         | 5,520         | 5,520         | 5,520         | 5,520         | 5,520          | 5,520          |
| Trade receivables                      | 16            | 118           | 83            | 103           | 151           | 209           | 313           | 422            | 566            |
| Cash and cash equivalents              | 4,478         | 3,704         | 20,012        | 13,547        | 10,759        | 13,932        | 28,093        | 53,319         | 84,054         |
| Other financial assets                 | 1,170         | 1,352         | 1,220         | 1,220         | 1,220         | 1,220         | 1,220         | 1,220          | 1,220          |
| Other current assets                   | 2,541         | 3,538         | 4,099         | 4,582         | 6,726         | 9,295         | 13,871        | 18,719         | 25,104         |
| <b>Total - current assets</b>          | <b>12,294</b> | <b>11,568</b> | <b>33,749</b> | <b>28,702</b> | <b>29,868</b> | <b>37,780</b> | <b>60,380</b> | <b>94,550</b>  | <b>137,061</b> |
| <b>Total assets</b>                    | <b>19,135</b> | <b>21,006</b> | <b>47,215</b> | <b>45,214</b> | <b>48,343</b> | <b>57,689</b> | <b>81,624</b> | <b>116,657</b> | <b>160,019</b> |
| Equity Share capital                   | 8             | 291           | 383           | 384           | 386           | 388           | 390           | 392            | 394            |
| Other equity                           | 5,451         | 4,639         | 25,344        | 20,318        | 16,772        | 18,139        | 27,971        | 48,062         | 71,794         |
| <b>Total - equity</b>                  | <b>5,459</b>  | <b>4,930</b>  | <b>25,726</b> | <b>20,702</b> | <b>17,158</b> | <b>18,527</b> | <b>28,361</b> | <b>48,454</b>  | <b>72,187</b>  |
| Borrowings                             | 309           | 1,169         | 3,674         | 3,674         | 3,674         | 3,674         | 3,674         | 3,674          | 3,674          |
| Other financial liabilities            | 103           | 119           | 69            | 73            | 76            | 80            | 84            | 88             | 93             |
| Provisions                             | 702           | 792           | 954           | 1,002         | 1,052         | 1,104         | 1,160         | 1,218          | 1,278          |
| Other non-current liabilities          | 1,798         | 2,264         | 2,839         | 2,921         | 3,006         | 3,096         | 3,191         | 3,290          | 3,394          |
| <b>Total - non-current liabilities</b> | <b>2,912</b>  | <b>4,344</b>  | <b>7,536</b>  | <b>7,669</b>  | <b>7,809</b>  | <b>7,955</b>  | <b>8,109</b>  | <b>8,270</b>   | <b>8,440</b>   |
| Short-term borrowings                  | 2,840         | 3,330         | 1,457         | 1,457         | 1,457         | 1,457         | 1,457         | 1,457          | 1,457          |
| Trade payables                         | 4,027         | 5,609         | 8,300         | 10,568        | 15,560        | 21,543        | 32,199        | 43,490         | 58,357         |
| Other financial liabilities            | 1,348         | 454           | 738           | 738           | 738           | 738           | 738           | 738            | 738            |
| Other current liabilities              | 1,742         | 1,150         | 2,208         | 2,831         | 4,372         | 6,220         | 9,511         | 12,998         | 17,590         |
| Provisions                             | 807           | 1,189         | 1,250         | 1,250         | 1,250         | 1,250         | 1,250         | 1,250          | 1,250          |
| <b>Total - current liabilities</b>     | <b>10,764</b> | <b>11,732</b> | <b>13,952</b> | <b>16,843</b> | <b>23,377</b> | <b>31,208</b> | <b>45,154</b> | <b>59,933</b>  | <b>79,392</b>  |
| <b>Total equity and liabilities</b>    | <b>19,135</b> | <b>21,006</b> | <b>47,215</b> | <b>45,214</b> | <b>48,343</b> | <b>57,689</b> | <b>81,624</b> | <b>116,657</b> | <b>160,019</b> |

Source: Company, CLSA

Ather is currently a net-cash company following its recent fund raising through equity dilution. However, given its early stage of operations and limited operating leverage, the company has been burning cash at a rate of c.Rs7bn-Rs10bn annually. As a result, we expect Ather's cash position to continue to decline until FY28CL, after which we believe the company will turn free-cash-flow positive. This inflection is expected to be driven by higher capacity utilisation at the new manufacturing plant and improved scale benefits, which should allow fixed costs to be absorbed more efficiently.

Figure 68

### Ather cashflow statement

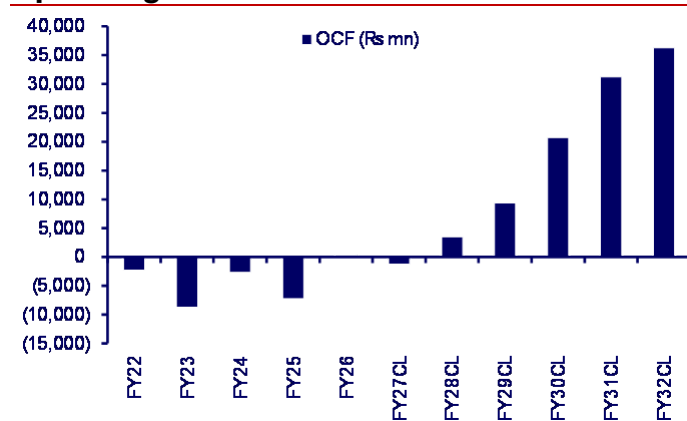
|                                  | FY24           | FY25            | FY26            | FY27CL         | FY28CL         | FY29CL         | FY30CL         | FY31CL         | FY32CL         |
|----------------------------------|----------------|-----------------|-----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| <b>Operating cash flow</b>       |                |                 |                 |                |                |                |                |                |                |
| Profit before tax                | (10,597)       | (8,123)         | (5,172)         | (5,025)        | (3,546)        | 1,367          | 9,832          | 20,091         | 31,642         |
| Add: Depreciation                | 1,467          | 1,710           | 1,729           | 2,321          | 3,913          | 4,450          | 5,360          | 6,340          | 6,862          |
| Less: Taxes paid                 | (1)            | (23)            | 2               | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | (7,910)        |
| Less: Financial income           | (353)          | (502)           | (1,513)         | (950)          | (440)          | (500)          | (1,000)        | (2,000)        | (3,000)        |
| Add: Interest expense            | 890            | 1,106           | 822             | 832            | 832            | 832            | 832            | 832            | 832            |
| Working capital changes          | 4,363          | (2,909)         | (2,604)         | 1,606          | 2,719          | 3,238          | 5,660          | 5,996          | 7,853          |
| <b>Total operating cashflow</b>  | <b>(2,676)</b> | <b>(7,207)</b>  | <b>319</b>      | <b>(1,216)</b> | <b>3,477</b>   | <b>9,387</b>   | <b>20,684</b>  | <b>31,260</b>  | <b>36,278</b>  |
| Operating, excl. working capital | (7,039)        | (4,298)         | 2,923           | (2,822)        | 758            | 6,149          | 15,024         | 25,263         | 28,425         |
| <b>Investing cash flow</b>       |                |                 |                 |                |                |                |                |                |                |
| Capital expenditure              | (1,159)        | (3,390)         | (5,061)         | (5,200)        | (5,700)        | (5,700)        | (6,500)        | (7,000)        | (7,500)        |
| Financial Income                 | 353            | 502             | 1,513           | 950            | 440            | 500            | 1,000          | 2,000          | 3,000          |
| <b>Total investing cashflow</b>  | <b>(2,281)</b> | <b>(3,782)</b>  | <b>(25,265)</b> | <b>(4,417)</b> | <b>(5,435)</b> | <b>(5,384)</b> | <b>(5,693)</b> | <b>(5,203)</b> | <b>(4,713)</b> |
| <b>Financing</b>                 |                |                 |                 |                |                |                |                |                |                |
| Share issuance                   | 9,011          | 866             | 25,401          | 1              | 2              | 2              | 2              | 2              | 2              |
| Loans (net)                      | (1,741)        | 7,347           | 671             | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              |
| Interest expense                 | (890)          | (1,106)         | (822)           | (832)          | (832)          | (832)          | (832)          | (832)          | (832)          |
| <b>Total financing cashflow</b>  | <b>6,332</b>   | <b>7,029</b>    | <b>24,965</b>   | <b>(831)</b>   | <b>(830)</b>   | <b>(830)</b>   | <b>(830)</b>   | <b>(830)</b>   | <b>(830)</b>   |
| <b>Free cash flow</b>            | <b>(3,835)</b> | <b>(10,597)</b> | <b>(4,742)</b>  | <b>(6,416)</b> | <b>(2,223)</b> | <b>3,687</b>   | <b>14,184</b>  | <b>24,260</b>  | <b>28,778</b>  |

Source: Company, CLSA

For the greenfield manufacturing facility at Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, which is planned with an eventual capacity of c.1m units, Ather has guided for total capex outlay of c.Rs20bn, to be incurred over a 3-4-year period. Combined with the ongoing Ebitda losses and associated cash burn, we expect free cash flow to remain negative over the next three years. Thereafter, with the ramp-up of the greenfield plant and improving scale benefits, we expect gradual improvement in capacity utilisation and fixed-cost absorption, supporting a transition towards positive free cash flow.

Figure 69

### Operating cash flow

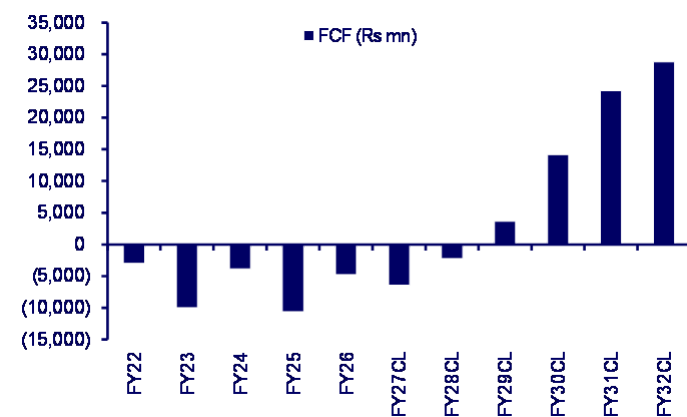


Source: Company, CLSA

Figure 70

### Free cash flow





Source: Company, CLSA

Cash flow remains the key item to watch, with Ather currently operating at negative OCF and FCF given its early-stage scale and ongoing investment cycle. That said, we expect a clear inflection in the cash flow trajectory as operating leverage builds, with the company likely turning Ebitda and PAT-positive by FY28-29CL.

Our estimates for Ather are below that of consensus, particularly for volume and profitability. We model lower volume ramp-up as well as a more gradual Ebitda margin expansion, reflecting a cautious stance on both the demand recovery and the pace of operating leverage benefits.

Figure 71

### Our estimates versus consensus

|                   | CLSA    |         |        | Consensus |        |         | % deviation |         |         |
|-------------------|---------|---------|--------|-----------|--------|---------|-------------|---------|---------|
|                   | FY27    | FY28    | FY29   | FY27      | FY28   | FY29    | FY27        | FY28    | FY29    |
| Revenue           | 45,378  | 66,815  | 92,508 | 53,001    | 72,543 | 105,557 | (14.4)      | (7.9)   | (12.4)  |
| Ebitda            | (2,822) | 758     | 6,149  | (2,260)   | 1,876  | 8,391   |             | (59.6)  | (26.7)  |
| PAT               | (5,025) | (3,546) | 1,247  | (4,138)   | (939)  | 5,173   |             |         | (75.9)  |
| Ebitda margin (%) | (6.2)   | 1.1     | 6.6    | (4.3)     | 2.6    | 7.9     | -200bps     | -150bps | -130bps |

Source: Bloomberg, CLSA

## Ather shareholding

Figure 72

### Ather shareholding

| Holders                                                                                | Share count        | % holding    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------|
| Tarun Mehta                                                                            | 20,362,732         | 5.3%         |
| Swapnil Jain                                                                           | 20,562,732         | 5.4%         |
| Hero MotoCorp                                                                          | 115,083,252        | 30.1%        |
| <b>Promotor Group</b>                                                                  | <b>156,008,716</b> | <b>40.8%</b> |
| SBI small Cap fund                                                                     | 27,558,296         | 7.2%         |
| Invesco India Focused Fund                                                             | 7,528,037          | 2.0%         |
| Motilal Oswal Large and Midcap fund                                                    | 14,150,360         | 3.7%         |
| Aditya Birla Sun Life Trustee Private Limited A/C Aditya Birla Sun Life Flexi Cap Fund | 7,484,083          | 2.0%         |
| Edelweiss Trusteeship Co Ltd Ac- Edelweiss Mf Ac- Edelweiss Mid Cap Fund               | 4,695,103          | 1.2%         |
| Others                                                                                 | 16,841,184         | 4.4%         |
| <b>Mutual Funds</b>                                                                    | <b>78,257,063</b>  | <b>20.5%</b> |
| AI Fs                                                                                  | 30,541,124         | 8.0%         |
| Insurance Companies                                                                    | 2,083,051          | 0.5%         |
| <b>DIIs</b>                                                                            | <b>110,881,238</b> | <b>29.0%</b> |
| Caladium Investment Pte Ltd                                                            | 35,410,916         | 9.3%         |
| Foreign Portfolio Investors Category I                                                 | 30,116,561         | 7.9%         |
| Foreign Portfolio Investors Category II                                                | 360,607            | 0.1%         |

|                          |                    |               |
|--------------------------|--------------------|---------------|
| <b>FII's</b>             | <b>65,888,084</b>  | <b>17.2%</b>  |
| <b>Public and others</b> | <b>49,895,126</b>  | <b>13.0%</b>  |
| <b>Total</b>             | <b>382,673,164</b> | <b>100.0%</b> |

Source: BSE, CLSA

## 8. Key risks

Rising geopolitical tension in the Middle East have recently driven upward pressure of key input costs, including aluminium, steel, copper and lithium-ion battery components, by disrupting global commodity supply chains. In the near to medium term, this is likely to weigh on Ather's gross margin, both through higher raw material prices and potential supply-side inefficiencies. However, we view these pressures as largely transitory, with margins expected to normalise over the longer term as supply chains stabilise and cost pass-through mechanisms, re-engineering initiatives and scale benefits take effect.

The key risk to our thesis remains slower-than-expected scaling of e2W adoption. Any material shortfall versus our penetration assumptions would directly impact Ather's volume growth, delay operating-leverage benefits and, in turn, compress Ebitda margin expansion. Given a meaningful portion of our profitability upside is driven by scale-led fixed-cost absorption, weaker adoption should result in slower margin normalisation and lower returns relative to expectations.

A potential supply crunch in memory chips presents an additional operational risk for Ather, as semiconductors are a critical component in its scooters, underpinning the digital dashboard, connectivity features and core vehicle electronics. Any prolonged shortage or sharp increase in chip prices could disrupt production schedules, elongate delivery timelines. While the company has historically managed supply risk through diversified sourcing and inventory planning, a sustained global chip shortage could still pose near-term execution headwinds, especially in a high-growth phase where volume ramp-up is central to operating-leverage benefits.

Concern around AI-driven disruptions in India's IT sector pose a downside risk to our volume assumptions, given a portion of Ather's customer base comprises IT professionals. Potential job losses or income uncertainty in this cohort could dampen discretionary spending, slowing e2W adoption and, in turn, impacting Ather's growth trajectory.

Near-term margin risks remain, driven by recent input cost inflation and tightness in semiconductor supply, which has led to elevated memory chip prices. We believe these factors could pose downside risk to our FY27CL Ebitda margin estimates, as cost pressure are likely to weigh on near-term profitability.

## 9. Board of directors & key managerial personnel

Figure 73

### Board of directors and key managerial personnel at Ather

| <b>Name</b>           | <b>Designation</b>                             |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Neelam Dhawan         | Chairperson and Independent Director           |
| Tarun Sanjay Mehta    | Executive Director and Chief Executive Officer |
| Swapnil Babanlal Jain | Executive Director and Chief Technical Officer |

|                         |                           |
|-------------------------|---------------------------|
| Ram Kuppuswamy          | Non-executive Director    |
| Pankaj Sood             | Non-executive Director    |
| Kaushik Dutta           | Independent Director      |
| Sanjay Nayak            | Independent Director      |
| Vivek Anand             | Non-executive Director    |
| Sohil Dilipkumar Parekh | Chief Financial Officer   |
| Ravneet Singh Phokela   | Chief Business Officer    |
| Harendra Saksena        | Chief Procurement Officer |
| Sanjeev Kumar Singh     | Chief Operating Officer   |
| Source: Company, CLSA   |                           |

**Neelam Dhawan:** Neelam Dhawan is the Chairperson and an Independent Director of Ather. She holds a bachelor's degree in arts (economics) from the University of Delhi and a master's degree in business administration from the University of Delhi. She was previously associated with Hewlett-Packard Enterprise India Private Limited as vice president, solutions sales and with HP India Sales Private Limited, Hewlett-Packard India Private Limited, Microsoft Corporation (India) Private Limited as managing director. Currently she serves as an Independent Director on the Boards of Hindustan Unilever Limited, Tech Mahindra Limited, Fractal Analytics Limited, Capillary Technologies India Limited and Data Security Council of India and as Director on the Boards of Nudge Lifeskills Foundation and Capita PLC. She has over 18 years of experience in information technology.

**Tarun Sanjay Mehta:** Tarun Sanjay Mehta is one of the Promoters, is an Executive Director and the Chief Executive Officer of Ather. He has been associated with Ather since incorporation and leads operations in the product, business as well as growth front. He holds a bachelor's and master's degree in technology in Engineering Design from Indian Institute of Technology, Madras under the dual degree programme. He has over 10 years of experience in the electric vehicles sector. He attended the CEO Forum (Quai d'Orsay) in Paris, France in 2023. He has received the 'Jagdish Khattar Rising Star' award from Acko Drive, the 'Young Entrepreneur' award from the All-India Management Association, the 'Keep Walking' award from India chapter of International Advertising Association and Walkers & Co and was named in the list of 'India 30 under 30' by Forbes India in 2018 and in Fortune '40 under 40' in 2019, 2021 and 2023.

**Swapnil Babanlal Jain:** Swapnil Babanlal Jain is one of the Promoters, is an Executive Director and the Chief Technical Officer of Ather. He has been associated with Ather since incorporation and works on both the long-term technology roadmap for Ather, as well as day-to-day aspects of creating an engineering team and culture. He holds a bachelor's and master's degree in technology in Engineering Design from Indian Institute of Technology, Madras under the dual degree programme. He has over 10 years of experience in the electric vehicles sector. He has received 'Young Entrepreneur' award from the All-India Management Association and was named in the list of 'India 30 under 30' by Forbes India in 2018 and in Fortune '40 under 40' in 2019, 2021 and 2023.

**Ram Kuppuswamy:** Ram Kuppuswamy is a Non-executive Director of Ather and a nominee of HMCL on our Board. He has been associated with Ather since January 27, 2023. He holds a bachelor's degree in engineering from Madurai Kamaraj University and a post-graduate diploma in management from the Indian Institute of Management, Ahmedabad. He was previously associated with Bharti Airtel Limited and VMWare Singapore Pte. Ltd. He is currently designated as the chief operations officer -manufacturing of HMCL. He has

over nine years of experience in supply chain management, logistics and customer fulfilment.

**Pankaj Sood:** Pankaj Sood is a Non-executive Director of Ather. He has been associated with Ather since November 11, 2022. He holds a bachelor's degree in chemical engineering from Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur and a post-graduate diploma in computer aided management from Indian Institute of Management, Kolkata. He was previously associated with Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Ernst & Young and SBI Capital Markets. He is currently employed by GIC in the Global Leadership Group. He has over 25 years of experience in finance, advisory and capital markets. Currently he is a Nominee Director on the Boards of Aditya Birla Fashion and Retail Limited, Bandhan Financial Holdings Limited and Bandhan Financial Services Limited and Director on the Boards of Spore Investment Management (India) Private Limited and Mphasis Limited and Whole-time Director on the Board of Singapore Investcorp (India) Private Limited and additional Director on the Board of Aditya Birla Lifestyle Brands Limited.

**Kaushik Dutta:** Kaushik Dutta is an Independent Director of Ather. He is a fellow member of the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India and a co-founder of Thought Arbitrage Research Institute; an independent not-for-profit research think tank working in areas of corporate governance and sustainability. He was also associated with Price Waterhouse & Co Chartered Accountants, LLP, and Lovelock & Lewes, Chartered Accountants as Partner for over 16 years. He was engaged as an expert on corporate governance by the Indian Institute of Corporate Affairs of the Ministry of Corporate Affairs in matters relating to future of corporate governance in India, was engaged as a consultant by the Serious Fraud Investigation Office, MCA and was a member of the Task Force to lay down the Criteria for Selection of the Strategic Partners for Various Platforms from the Private Sector Industry. He has over 25 years of experience in governance, policy and audit. Currently he serves as an Independent Director on the Boards of PB Fintech Limited, Eternal Limited, Zinka Logistics Solutions Limited, Hero FinCorp Limited and Shiprocket Limited and as Director on the Boards of Paisabazaar Marketing and Consulting Private Limited, Resilient Innovations Private Limited, Thought Arbitrage Research Institute and Blink Commerce Private Limited.

**Sanjay Nayak:** Sanjay Nayak is an Independent Director of Ather. He has been associated with Ather since August 27, 2024. He holds a bachelor's degree in science (engineering) from Birla Institute of Technology, Ranchi University and a master's degree in science from North Carolina State University, Raleigh. He was previously associated with Tejas Networks Limited as its managing director and chief executive officer. He has over 23 years of industry experience and has expertise in electronics and telecommunications. Currently he serves as an Independent Director on the Board of Epic Electronics Products Foundation and as Director on the Board of Shramol Technologies Private Limited and IIMBx Digital Learning Foundation.

**Vivek Anand:** Mr. Vivek Anand is a finance professional with over three decades of diverse industry experience in FMCG, telecom, paints, consumer healthcare and real estate. He joined Hero MotoCorp in March 2024 to spearhead the finance function. He has worked with Hindustan Unilever Limited, GSK, Unilever Bangladesh, Telenor, GSK and DLF. In his previous role

as Group Chief Financial Officer at DLF Ltd based in Gurugram, Mr. Vivek instilled a culture of performance into the Company and was instrumental in driving growth and profitability while steering the Company to an all-time high market cap of \$27Bn (3.5x growth in 4 years). In his earlier role, Mr. Vivek was part of the lead team at GSK Healthcare during India's largest business divestment in the consumer sector valued at \$4Bn. This involved divestment of HFD business to Unilever, involving sale of heritage brands like Horlicks and Boost sold in more than 20 countries. A Chartered Accountant, Mr. Vivek has significant experience in Indian and international markets with a strong acumen in Finance, Treasury, Mergers & Acquisitions, Corporate Planning, Investor Relations, Tax Planning, Risk Management and Information Technology. Currently he serves as Director on the Board of HMC MM Auto Limited.

**Sohil Dilipkumar Parekh:** Sohil Dilipkumar Parekh is the Chief Financial Officer of Ather, overseeing financial strategy, reporting, operations, fundraising, and tax matters. A member of the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India, Sohil holds a bachelor's degree in commerce and a bachelor's degree in law, each from Gujarat University. Prior to joining Ather on September 9, 2022, Sohil had been associated with Claris Limited, as well as had past work experience across various other sectors, including waste-to-energy, pharmaceuticals, market research, business process outsourcing, IT and ITES. In addition to his professional achievements, Sohil is an ultra-endurance athlete and has represented India in several Full Distance Ironman Triathlons, as well as participated in long-distance cycling and running events.

## Investment thesis

Ather Energy has been gaining market share driven by rapid network expansion, broader geographic reach and the launch of feature-rich electric scooters. With the upcoming EL platform, Ather Energy aims to enter the Rs100k-Rs120k price segment, expanding its addressable market. Backed by strong execution and a differentiated proprietary hardware-software ecosystem, we believe Ather Energy is well positioned to win in the mass segment while retaining its premium features. Notably, its gross margin per vehicle already exceeds that of legacy ICE 2W OEMs, and with scale, we expect meaningful Ebitda margin expansion.

## Catalysts

Rapid adoption of electric two-wheelers on back of the push from the government, the increase in fuel prices making electric two-wheelers more economical in-terms of total cost of ownership, market share gains in the Rs100k-Rs120k segment on back of its EL platform launch and network expansion.

## Valuation details

We value Ather Energy at a 40x (+1 standard deviation of TVS Motor) FY32CL EPS (post margin normalisation), and discount this back to four years using a COE of 13.6%.

## Investment risks

Ather Energy is a leading vertically integrated electric two wheeler player in India with strong branding, proprietary software and charging infrastructure. Expansion into the mass segments via the Rizta is driving growth. With rising

EV adoption, market share gains, improving margins through its EL platform and operating leverage, Ather Energy is well positioned for rapid volume growth and profitability improvement.

Figure 74

### Earnings and balance-sheet risk scores (lower the better)

|                                                | Score      | Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Earnings-quality flags</b>                  |            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Capex indiscipline                             | 1          | Ather announced a greenfield expansion, which led to an increase in capex.                                                                                                                                                              |
| Cash burn                                      | 1          | Ather is in the startup phase, and as volumes ramp up, fixed costs per vehicle are expected to decline, improving profitability and, in turn, strengthening free cash flow (FCF).                                                       |
| Rising non-core or intangibles                 | 1          | Increase in intangibles is on the back of continuous improvement in its software stack.                                                                                                                                                 |
| Rising working capital                         | 0          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Poor cash conversion                           | 0          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Earnings-quality risk score (EQRS)</b>      | <b>3/5</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Balance-sheet-quality flags</b>             |            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Cash burn                                      | 1          | Ather is in the startup phase, and as volumes ramp up, fixed costs per vehicle are expected to decline, improving profitability and, in turn, strengthening free cash flow (FCF).                                                       |
| Excessive leverage                             | 0          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Frequent fundraising                           | 1          | Due to its startup phase and higher fixed costs at a lower scale, Ather is experiencing cash burn and therefore needed to raise funds. However, with scale improvement the cash burn would continue to reduce and turn to positive FCF. |
| Liquidity concerns                             | 1          | With the recent fundraise through the IPO, liquidity has improved significantly.                                                                                                                                                        |
| Operational stress                             | 1          | Ather has already been delivering higher gross profit per vehicle compared to other ICE OEMs; therefore, with improvements in scale, we believe Ebitda margins would improve significantly.                                             |
| <b>Balance-sheet-quality risk score (BQRS)</b> | <b>4/5</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

Source: CLSA

## Detailed financials

### Profit & Loss (Rsm)

| Year to 31 March                 | 2023A          | 2024A          | 2025A          | 2026A          | 2027CL         | 2028CL         | 2029CL        |
|----------------------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|---------------|
| Revenue                          | 17,809         | 17,538         | 22,550         | 36,718         | 45,378         | 66,815         | 92,508        |
| Cogs (ex-D&A)                    | (15,954)       | (16,318)       | (18,768)       | (28,976)       | (36,303)       | (51,448)       | (69,381)      |
| <b>Gross Profit (ex-D&amp;A)</b> | <b>1,855</b>   | <b>1,220</b>   | <b>3,782</b>   | <b>7,742</b>   | <b>9,076</b>   | <b>15,367</b>  | <b>23,127</b> |
| Research & development costs     | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -             |
| Selling & marketing expenses     | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -             |
| Other SG&A                       | (5,583)        | (4,375)        | (5,467)        | (7,009)        | (7,261)        | (9,688)        | (11,101)      |
| Other Op Expenses ex-D&A         | (3,348)        | (3,692)        | (4,124)        | (4,816)        | (4,638)        | (4,921)        | (5,877)       |
| <b>Op Ebitda</b>                 | <b>(7,076)</b> | <b>(6,847)</b> | <b>(5,809)</b> | <b>(4,084)</b> | <b>(2,822)</b> | <b>758</b>     | <b>6,149</b>  |
| Depreciation/amortisation        | (1,128)        | (1,467)        | (1,710)        | (1,729)        | (2,321)        | (3,913)        | (4,450)       |
| <b>Op Ebit</b>                   | <b>(8,204)</b> | <b>(8,314)</b> | <b>(7,519)</b> | <b>(5,813)</b> | <b>(5,143)</b> | <b>(3,154)</b> | <b>1,699</b>  |
| Interest income                  | 0              | 0              | 0              | 0              | 0              | 0              | 0             |
| Interest expense                 | (650)          | (890)          | (1,106)        | (822)          | (832)          | (832)          | (832)         |
| <b>Net interest inc/(exp)</b>    | <b>(650)</b>   | <b>(890)</b>   | <b>(1,106)</b> | <b>(822)</b>   | <b>(832)</b>   | <b>(832)</b>   | <b>(832)</b>  |
| Associates/investments           | 209            | 353            | 502            | 1,513          | 950            | 440            | 500           |
| Forex/other income               | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -             |
| Asset sales/other cash items     | -              | 0              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -             |
| Provisions/other non-cash items  | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -             |

|                                        |                |                 |                |                |                |                |              |
|----------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|--------------|
| Asset revaluation/Exceptional items    | -              | (1,746)         | -              | (50)           | -              | -              | -            |
| <b>Profit before tax</b>               | <b>(8,645)</b> | <b>(10,597)</b> | <b>(8,123)</b> | <b>(5,172)</b> | <b>(5,025)</b> | <b>(3,546)</b> | <b>1,367</b> |
| Taxation                               | -              | -               | -              | -              | -              | -              | -            |
| <b>Profit after tax</b>                | <b>(8,645)</b> | <b>(10,597)</b> | <b>(8,123)</b> | <b>(5,172)</b> | <b>(5,025)</b> | <b>(3,546)</b> | <b>1,367</b> |
| Preference dividends                   | -              | -               | -              | -              | -              | -              | -            |
| <b>Profit for period</b>               | <b>(8,645)</b> | <b>(10,597)</b> | <b>(8,123)</b> | <b>(5,172)</b> | <b>(5,025)</b> | <b>(3,546)</b> | <b>1,367</b> |
| Minority interest                      | 0              | 0               | 0              | 0              | 0              | 0              | 0            |
| <b>Net profit</b>                      | <b>(8,645)</b> | <b>(10,597)</b> | <b>(8,123)</b> | <b>(5,172)</b> | <b>(5,025)</b> | <b>(3,546)</b> | <b>1,367</b> |
| Extraordinaries/others                 | 0              | 0               | 0              | 0              | 0              | 0              | 0            |
| <b>Profit avail to ordinary shares</b> | <b>(8,645)</b> | <b>(10,597)</b> | <b>(8,123)</b> | <b>(5,172)</b> | <b>(5,025)</b> | <b>(3,546)</b> | <b>1,367</b> |
| Dividends                              | -              | -               | -              | -              | -              | -              | -            |
| <b>Retained profit</b>                 | <b>(8,645)</b> | <b>(10,597)</b> | <b>(8,123)</b> | <b>(5,172)</b> | <b>(5,025)</b> | <b>(3,546)</b> | <b>1,367</b> |
| <b>Adjusted profit</b>                 | <b>(8,645)</b> | <b>(8,851)</b>  | <b>(8,123)</b> | <b>(5,121)</b> | <b>(5,025)</b> | <b>(3,546)</b> | <b>1,367</b> |
| EPS (Rs)                               | (34.3)         | (27.7)          | (21.2)         | (13.4)         | (13.0)         | (9.1)          | 3.5          |
| Adj EPS [pre excep] (Rs)               | (34.3)         | (23.2)          | (21.2)         | (13.3)         | (13.0)         | (9.1)          | 3.5          |
| Core EPS (Rs)                          | (34.3)         | (27.7)          | (21.2)         | (13.4)         | (13.0)         | (9.1)          | 3.5          |
| DPS (Rs)                               | 0.0            | 0.0             | 0.0            | 0.0            | 0.0            | 0.0            | 0.0          |

## Profit & loss ratios

| Year to 31 March                     | 2023A   | 2024A   | 2025A   | 2026A  | 2027CL | 2028CL | 2029CL |
|--------------------------------------|---------|---------|---------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| <b>Growth (%)</b>                    |         |         |         |        |        |        |        |
| Revenue growth (% YoY)               | 335.5   | (1.5)   | 28.6    | 62.8   | 23.6   | 47.2   | 38.5   |
| Ebitda growth (% YoY)                | nm      | nm      | nm      | nm     | nm     | nm     | 711.0  |
| Ebit growth (% YoY)                  | nm      | nm      | nm      | nm     | nm     | nm     | nm     |
| Net profit growth (%)                | nm      | nm      | nm      | nm     | nm     | nm     | nm     |
| EPS growth (% YoY)                   | nm      | nm      | nm      | nm     | nm     | nm     | nm     |
| Adj EPS growth (% YoY)               | nm      | nm      | nm      | nm     | nm     | nm     | nm     |
| DPS growth (% YoY)                   | -       | -       | -       | -      | -      | -      | -      |
| Core EPS growth (% YoY)              | nm      | nm      | nm      | nm     | nm     | nm     | nm     |
| <b>Margins (%)</b>                   |         |         |         |        |        |        |        |
| Gross margin (%)                     | 10.4    | 7.0     | 16.8    | 21.1   | 20.0   | 23.0   | 25.0   |
| Ebitda margin (%)                    | (39.7)  | (39.0)  | (25.8)  | (11.1) | (6.2)  | 1.1    | 6.6    |
| Ebit margin (%)                      | (46.1)  | (47.4)  | (33.3)  | (15.8) | (11.3) | (4.7)  | 1.8    |
| Net profit margin (%)                | (48.5)  | (60.4)  | (36.0)  | (14.1) | (11.1) | (5.3)  | 1.5    |
| Core profit margin                   | (48.5)  | (60.4)  | (36.0)  | (14.1) | (11.1) | (5.3)  | 1.5    |
| Op cashflow margin                   | (48.9)  | (15.3)  | (32.0)  | 0.9    | (2.7)  | 5.2    | 10.1   |
| <b>Returns (%)</b>                   |         |         |         |        |        |        |        |
| ROE (%)                              | (206.2) | (182.8) | (156.4) | (33.7) | (21.6) | (18.7) | 7.7    |
| ROA (%)                              | (58.7)  | (42.7)  | (37.5)  | (17.0) | (11.1) | (6.7)  | 3.2    |
| ROIC (%)                             | (98.2)  | (91.4)  | (96.2)  | (49.2) | (33.2) | (19.7) | 11.5   |
| ROCE (%)                             | (98.2)  | (91.4)  | (96.2)  | (49.3) | (33.2) | (19.7) | 11.5   |
| <b>Other key ratios (%)</b>          |         |         |         |        |        |        |        |
| Effective tax rate (%)               | 0.0     | 0.0     | 0.0     | 0.0    | 0.0    | 0.0    | 0.0    |
| Ebitda/net int exp (x)               | (10.9)  | (7.7)   | (5.3)   | (5.0)  | (3.4)  | 0.9    | 7.4    |
| Exceptional or extraord. inc/PBT (%) | -       | -       | -       | -      | -      | -      | -      |
| Dividend payout (%)                  | -       | -       | -       | -      | -      | -      | 0.0    |

Source: www.clsa.com

## Balance sheet (Rsm)

| Year to 31 March            | 2023A         | 2024A         | 2025A         | 2026A         | 2027CL        | 2028CL        | 2029CL        |
|-----------------------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| Cash & equivalents          | 1,762         | 4,478         | 3,704         | 20,012        | 13,547        | 10,759        | 13,932        |
| Accounts receivable         | 12            | 16            | 118           | 83            | 103           | 151           | 209           |
| Inventories                 | 2,574         | 1,167         | 2,446         | 2,816         | 3,730         | 5,492         | 7,603         |
| Other current assets        | 8,735         | 6,631         | 5,296         | 10,837        | 11,322        | 13,466        | 16,035        |
| <b>Current assets</b>       | <b>13,083</b> | <b>12,292</b> | <b>11,564</b> | <b>33,747</b> | <b>28,702</b> | <b>29,868</b> | <b>37,780</b> |
| Fixed assets                | 5,819         | 5,295         | 7,380         | 9,676         | 12,555        | 14,342        | 15,592        |
| Investments                 | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             |
| Goodwill                    | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             |
| Other intangible assets     | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             |
| Other non-current assets    | 866           | 1,548         | 2,062         | 3,792         | 3,958         | 4,133         | 4,317         |
| <b>Total assets</b>         | <b>19,768</b> | <b>19,135</b> | <b>21,006</b> | <b>47,215</b> | <b>45,214</b> | <b>48,343</b> | <b>57,689</b> |
| Short term loans/OD         | 3,647         | 2,840         | 3,330         | 1,457         | 1,457         | 1,457         | 1,457         |
| Accounts payable            | 3,837         | 4,027         | 5,609         | 8,300         | 10,568        | 15,560        | 21,543        |
| Accrued expenses            | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             |
| Taxes payable               | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             |
| Other current liabs         | 2,711         | 3,897         | 2,793         | 4,196         | 4,819         | 6,360         | 8,208         |
| <b>Current liabilities</b>  | <b>10,195</b> | <b>10,764</b> | <b>11,732</b> | <b>13,952</b> | <b>16,843</b> | <b>23,377</b> | <b>31,208</b> |
| Long-term debt/leases/other | 3,436         | 2,912         | 4,344         | 7,536         | 7,669         | 7,809         | 7,955         |
| Convertible bonds           | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             |
| Provisions/other LT liabs   | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             |
| <b>Total liabilities</b>    | <b>13,631</b> | <b>13,676</b> | <b>16,076</b> | <b>21,489</b> | <b>24,512</b> | <b>31,185</b> | <b>39,163</b> |
| Share capital               | 6             | 8             | 291           | 383           | 384           | 386           | 388           |

|                                 |               |               |               |               |               |               |               |
|---------------------------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| Retained earnings               | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             | -             |
| Reserves/others                 | 6,131         | 5,451         | 4,639         | 25,344        | 20,318        | 16,772        | 18,139        |
| <b>Shareholder funds</b>        | <b>6,137</b>  | <b>5,459</b>  | <b>4,930</b>  | <b>25,726</b> | <b>20,702</b> | <b>17,158</b> | <b>18,527</b> |
| Minorities/other equity         | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             | 0             |
| <b>Total equity</b>             | <b>6,137</b>  | <b>5,459</b>  | <b>4,930</b>  | <b>25,726</b> | <b>20,702</b> | <b>17,158</b> | <b>18,527</b> |
| <b>Total liabs &amp; equity</b> | <b>19,768</b> | <b>19,135</b> | <b>21,006</b> | <b>47,215</b> | <b>45,214</b> | <b>48,343</b> | <b>57,689</b> |
| Total debt                      | 7,083         | 5,752         | 7,674         | 8,993         | 9,126         | 9,265         | 9,412         |
| Net debt                        | 5,321         | 1,274         | 3,970         | (11,019)      | (4,422)       | (1,494)       | (4,520)       |
| Adjusted EV                     | 237,297       | 352,887       | 356,830       | 341,430       | 349,806       | 354,522       | 353,293       |
| BVPS (Rs)                       | 24.4          | 14.3          | 12.8          | 66.7          | 53.4          | 44.0          | 47.3          |

## Balance sheet ratios

| Year to 31 March                     | 2023A   | 2024A   | 2025A   | 2026A   | 2027CL  | 2028CL  | 2029CL  |
|--------------------------------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| <b>Key ratios</b>                    |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |
| Current ratio (x)                    | 1.3     | 1.1     | 1.0     | 2.4     | 1.7     | 1.3     | 1.2     |
| Growth in total assets (% YoY)       | 141.5   | (3.2)   | 9.8     | 124.8   | (4.2)   | 6.9     | 19.3    |
| Growth in capital employed (% YoY)   | 118.2   | (41.3)  | 32.2    | 65.3    | 10.7    | (3.8)   | (10.6)  |
| Net debt to operating cashflow (x)   | (0.6)   | (0.5)   | (0.6)   | -       | -       | -       | -       |
| Gross debt to operating cashflow (x) | (0.8)   | (2.1)   | (1.1)   | 28.2    | (7.5)   | 2.7     | 1.0     |
| Gross debt to Ebitda (x)             | (1.0)   | (0.8)   | (1.3)   | (2.2)   | (3.2)   | 12.2    | 1.5     |
| Net debt/Ebitda (x)                  | (0.8)   | (0.2)   | (0.7)   | -       | -       | -       | -       |
| <b>Gearing</b>                       |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |
| Net debt/equity (%)                  | 86.7    | 23.3    | 80.5    | (42.8)  | (21.4)  | (8.7)   | (24.4)  |
| Gross debt/equity (%)                | 115.4   | 105.4   | 155.7   | 35.0    | 44.1    | 54.0    | 50.8    |
| Interest cover (x)                   | (12.6)  | (9.3)   | (6.8)   | (7.1)   | (6.2)   | (3.8)   | 2.0     |
| Debt cover (x)                       | (1.2)   | (0.5)   | (0.9)   | 0.0     | (0.1)   | 0.4     | 1.0     |
| Net cash per share (Rs)              | (21.1)  | (3.3)   | (10.3)  | 28.6    | 11.4    | 3.8     | 11.5    |
| <b>Working capital analysis</b>      |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |
| Inventory days                       | 36.4    | 41.8    | 35.1    | 33.1    | 32.9    | 32.7    | 34.4    |
| Debtor days                          | 0.2     | 0.3     | 1.1     | 1.0     | 0.7     | 0.7     | 0.7     |
| Creditor days                        | 57.7    | 88.0    | 93.7    | 87.6    | 94.9    | 92.7    | 97.6    |
| Working capital/Sales (%)            | 26.8    | (0.6)   | (2.4)   | 3.4     | (0.5)   | (4.2)   | (6.4)   |
| <b>Capital employed analysis</b>     |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |
| Sales/Capital employed (%)           | 155.4   | 260.6   | 253.5   | 249.7   | 278.7   | 426.6   | 660.5   |
| EV/Capital employed (%)              | 2,071.0 | 5,242.7 | 4,011.1 | 2,321.7 | 2,148.6 | 2,263.4 | 2,522.4 |
| Working capital/Capital employed (%) | 41.7    | (1.6)   | (6.1)   | 8.4     | (1.4)   | (17.9)  | (42.2)  |
| Fixed capital/Capital employed (%)   | 50.8    | 78.7    | 83.0    | 65.8    | 77.1    | 91.6    | 111.3   |
| <b>Other ratios (%)</b>              |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |
| PB (x)                               | 37.9    | 64.5    | 71.8    | 13.8    | 17.3    | 20.9    | 19.5    |
| EV/Ebitda (x)                        | (33.5)  | (51.5)  | (61.4)  | (83.6)  | (123.9) | 467.6   | 57.5    |
| EV/OCF (x)                           | (27.2)  | (131.9) | (49.5)  | 1,070.6 | (287.6) | 101.9   | 37.6    |
| EV/FCF (x)                           | (23.7)  | (92.0)  | (33.7)  | (72.0)  | (54.5)  | (159.5) | 95.8    |
| EV/Sales (x)                         | 13.3    | 20.1    | 15.8    | 9.3     | 7.7     | 5.3     | 3.8     |
| Capex/depreciation (%)               | 116.8   | 79.0    | 198.2   | 292.7   | 224.0   | 145.7   | 128.1   |

Source: www.clsa.com

## Cashflow (Rsm)

| Year to 31 March                         | 2023A           | 2024A          | 2025A           | 2026A          | 2027CL         | 2028CL         | 2029CL         |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------|-----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| <b>Operating profit</b>                  | <b>(8,204)</b>  | <b>(8,314)</b> | <b>(7,519)</b>  | <b>(5,813)</b> | <b>(5,143)</b> | <b>(3,154)</b> | <b>1,699</b>   |
| Operating adjustments                    | (441)           | (2,283)        | (604)           | 641            | 118            | (392)          | (332)          |
| Depreciation/amortisation                | 1,128           | 1,467          | 1,710           | 1,729          | 2,321          | 3,913          | 4,450          |
| Working capital changes                  | (3,755)         | 4,363          | (2,909)         | (2,604)        | 1,606          | 2,719          | 3,238          |
| Interest paid / other financial expenses | 650             | 890            | 1,106           | 822            | 832            | 832            | 832            |
| Tax paid                                 | (14)            | (1)            | (23)            | 2              | 0              | 0              | 0              |
| Other non-cash operating items           | 1,923           | 1,202          | 1,032           | 5,542          | (950)          | (440)          | (500)          |
| <b>Net operating cashflow</b>            | <b>(8,713)</b>  | <b>(2,676)</b> | <b>(7,207)</b>  | <b>319</b>     | <b>(1,216)</b> | <b>3,477</b>   | <b>9,387</b>   |
| Capital expenditure                      | (1,318)         | (1,159)        | (3,390)         | (5,061)        | (5,200)        | (5,700)        | (5,700)        |
| <b>Free cashflow</b>                     | <b>(10,031)</b> | <b>(3,835)</b> | <b>(10,597)</b> | <b>(4,742)</b> | <b>(6,416)</b> | <b>(2,223)</b> | <b>3,687</b>   |
| Acq/inv/disposals                        | (237)           | (1,387)        | (786)           | (21,409)       | -              | -              | -              |
| Int, invt & associate div                | (1,718)         | (317)          | 2,998           | 20,097         | 783            | 265            | 316            |
| <b>Net investing cashflow</b>            | <b>(3,273)</b>  | <b>(2,863)</b> | <b>(1,178)</b>  | <b>(6,373)</b> | <b>(4,417)</b> | <b>(5,435)</b> | <b>(5,384)</b> |
| Increase in loans                        | 1,898           | (1,741)        | 7,347           | 671            | -              | -              | -              |
| Dividends                                | 0               | 0              | 0               | 0              | 0              | 0              | 0              |
| Net equity raised/others                 | 11,276          | 8,073          | (318)           | 24,295         | (831)          | (830)          | (830)          |
| <b>Net financing cashflow</b>            | <b>13,174</b>   | <b>6,332</b>   | <b>7,029</b>    | <b>24,965</b>  | <b>(831)</b>   | <b>(830)</b>   | <b>(830)</b>   |
| Incr/(decr) in net cash                  | 1,188           | 793            | (1,356)         | 18,912         | (6,464)        | (2,788)        | 3,173          |
| Exch rate movements                      | -               | -              | -               | -              | -              | -              | -              |
| <b>Opening cash</b>                      | <b>574</b>      | <b>3,685</b>   | <b>5,060</b>    | <b>1,100</b>   | <b>20,012</b>  | <b>13,547</b>  | <b>10,759</b>  |



|              |        |        |        |        |        |        |        |
|--------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Closing cash | 1,762  | 4,478  | 3,704  | 20,012 | 13,547 | 10,759 | 13,932 |
| OCF PS (Rs)  | (34.6) | (7.0)  | (18.8) | 0.8    | (3.1)  | 8.9    | 24.0   |
| FCF PS (Rs)  | (39.8) | (10.0) | (27.6) | (12.3) | (16.5) | (5.7)  | 9.4    |

## Cashflow ratio analysis

| Year to 31 March                    | 2023A  | 2024A  | 2025A  | 2026A   | 2027CL  | 2028CL | 2029CL |
|-------------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|---------|---------|--------|--------|
| <b>Growth (%)</b>                   |        |        |        |         |         |        |        |
| Op cashflow growth (% YoY)          | nm     | nm     | nm     | nm      | (481.4) | nm     | 169.9  |
| FCF growth (% YoY)                  | -      | -      | -      | -       | -       | -      | -      |
| Capex growth (%)                    | 82.5   | (12.1) | 192.5  | 49.3    | 2.8     | 9.6    | 0.0    |
| <b>Other key ratios (%)</b>         |        |        |        |         |         |        |        |
| Capex/sales (%)                     | 7.4    | 6.6    | 15.0   | 13.8    | 11.5    | 8.5    | 6.2    |
| Capex/op cashflow (%)               | (15.1) | (43.3) | (47.0) | 1,586.9 | (427.5) | 163.9  | 60.7   |
| Operating cashflow payout ratio (%) | -      | -      | -      | 0.0     | -       | 0.0    | 0.0    |
| Cashflow payout ratio (%)           | -      | -      | -      | -       | -       | -      | -      |
| Free cashflow payout ratio (%)      | -      | -      | -      | -       | -       | -      | -      |

## DuPont analysis

| Year to 31 March     | 2023A   | 2024A   | 2025A   | 2026A  | 2027CL | 2028CL | 2029CL |
|----------------------|---------|---------|---------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Ebit margin (%)      | (46.1)  | (47.4)  | (33.3)  | (15.8) | (11.3) | (4.7)  | 1.8    |
| Asset turnover (x)   | 1.3     | 0.9     | 1.1     | 1.1    | 1.0    | 1.4    | 1.7    |
| Interest burden (x)  | 1.1     | 1.3     | 1.1     | 0.9    | 1.0    | 1.1    | 0.8    |
| Tax burden (x)       | 1.0     | 1.0     | 1.0     | 1.0    | 1.0    | 1.0    | 1.0    |
| Return on assets (%) | (58.7)  | (42.7)  | (37.5)  | (17.0) | (11.1) | (6.7)  | 3.2    |
| Leverage (x)         | 3.3     | 3.4     | 3.9     | 2.2    | 2.0    | 2.5    | 3.0    |
| ROE (%)              | (206.2) | (182.8) | (156.4) | (33.7) | (21.6) | (18.7) | 7.7    |

## EVA® analysis

| Year to 31 March                     | 2023A   | 2024A   | 2025A   | 2026A   | 2027CL  | 2028CL  | 2029CL |
|--------------------------------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|--------|
| Ebit adj for tax                     | (8,204) | (8,314) | (7,519) | (5,813) | (5,143) | (3,154) | 1,699  |
| Average invested capital             | 8,355   | 9,096   | 7,817   | 11,804  | 15,494  | 15,972  | 14,835 |
| ROIC (%)                             | (98.2)  | (91.4)  | (96.2)  | (49.2)  | (33.2)  | (19.7)  | 11.5   |
| Cost of equity (%)                   | 11.8    | 11.8    | 11.8    | 11.8    | 11.8    | 11.8    | 11.8   |
| Cost of debt (adj for tax)           | 9.0     | 9.0     | 9.0     | 9.0     | 9.0     | 9.0     | 9.0    |
| Weighted average cost of capital (%) | 10.8    | 10.8    | 10.8    | 10.8    | 10.8    | 10.8    | 10.8   |
| EVA/IC (%)                           | (109.0) | (102.2) | (107.0) | (60.1)  | (44.0)  | (30.6)  | 0.6    |
| EVA (Rsm)                            | (9,109) | (9,299) | (8,366) | (7,091) | (6,822) | (4,885) | 92     |

Source: www.clsa.com

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